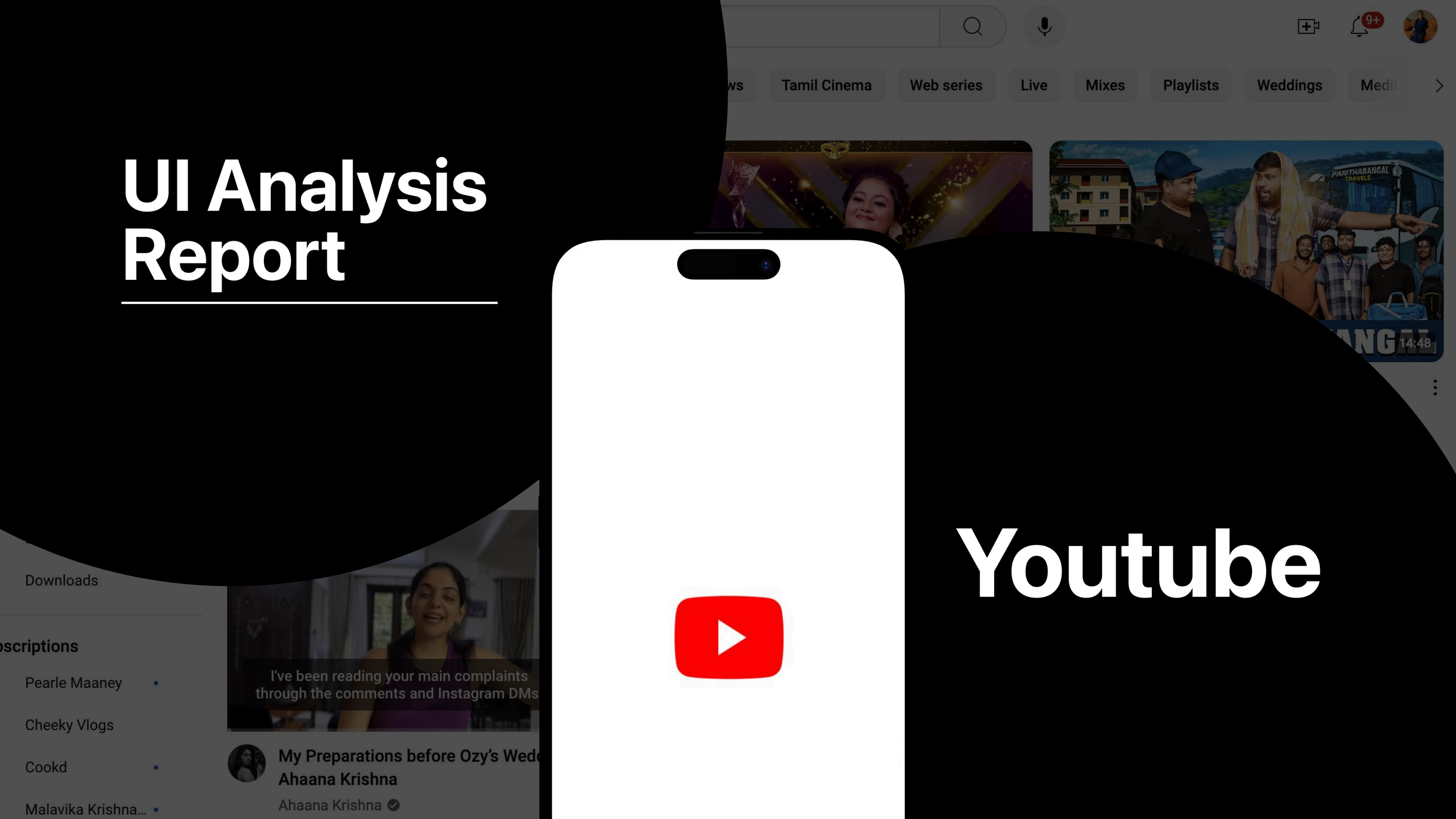
UI Analysis Report



Youtube

Youtube

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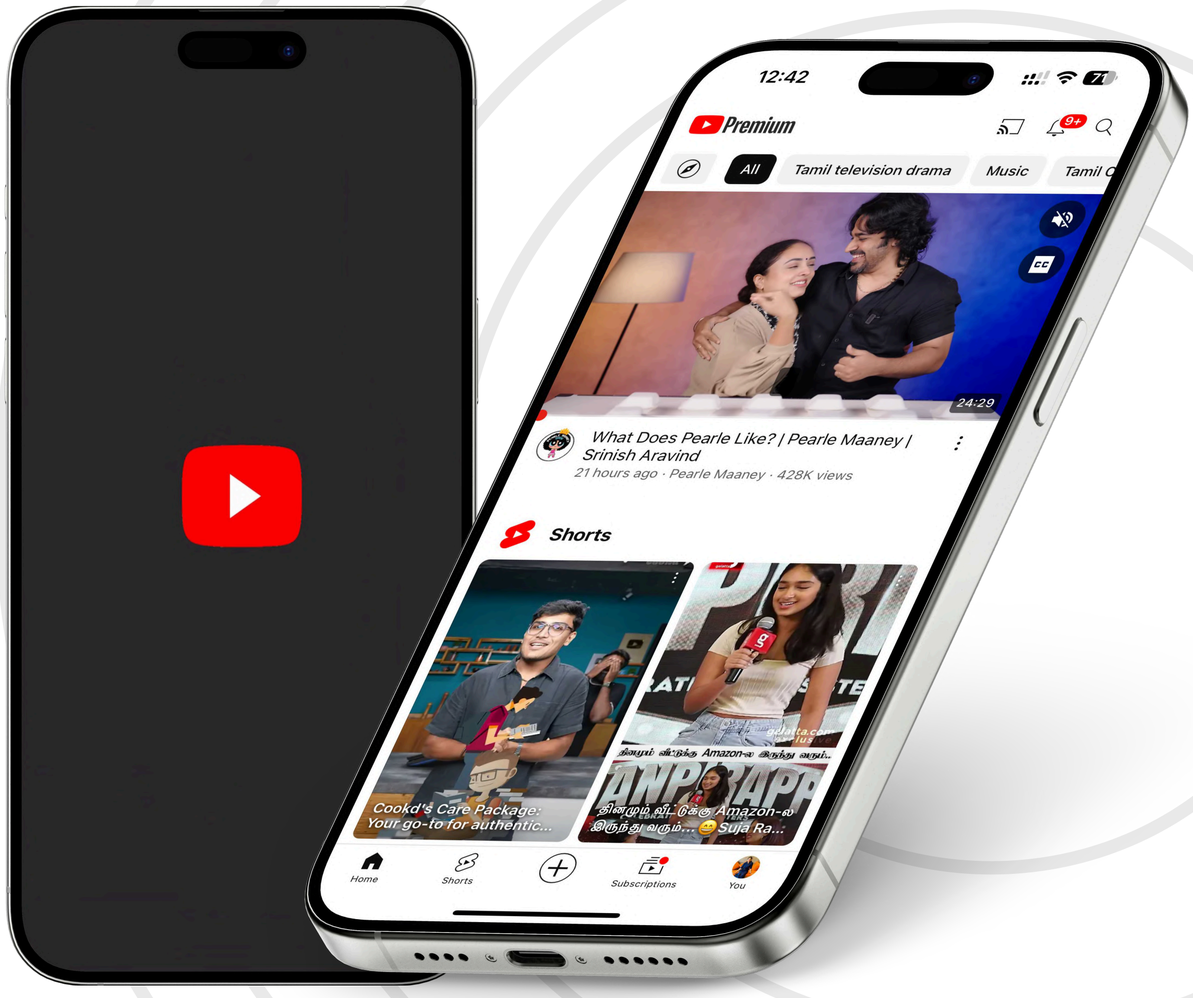
Introduction

UI analysis report

My project analyzes YouTube's UI, focusing on key design elements like navigation, thumbnails, and interactive buttons.
It also considers accessibility features.
This research led to the proposal of a Quick Access Tool for User History, enhancing usability and engagement through consistent navigation and visual clarity.



Introduction

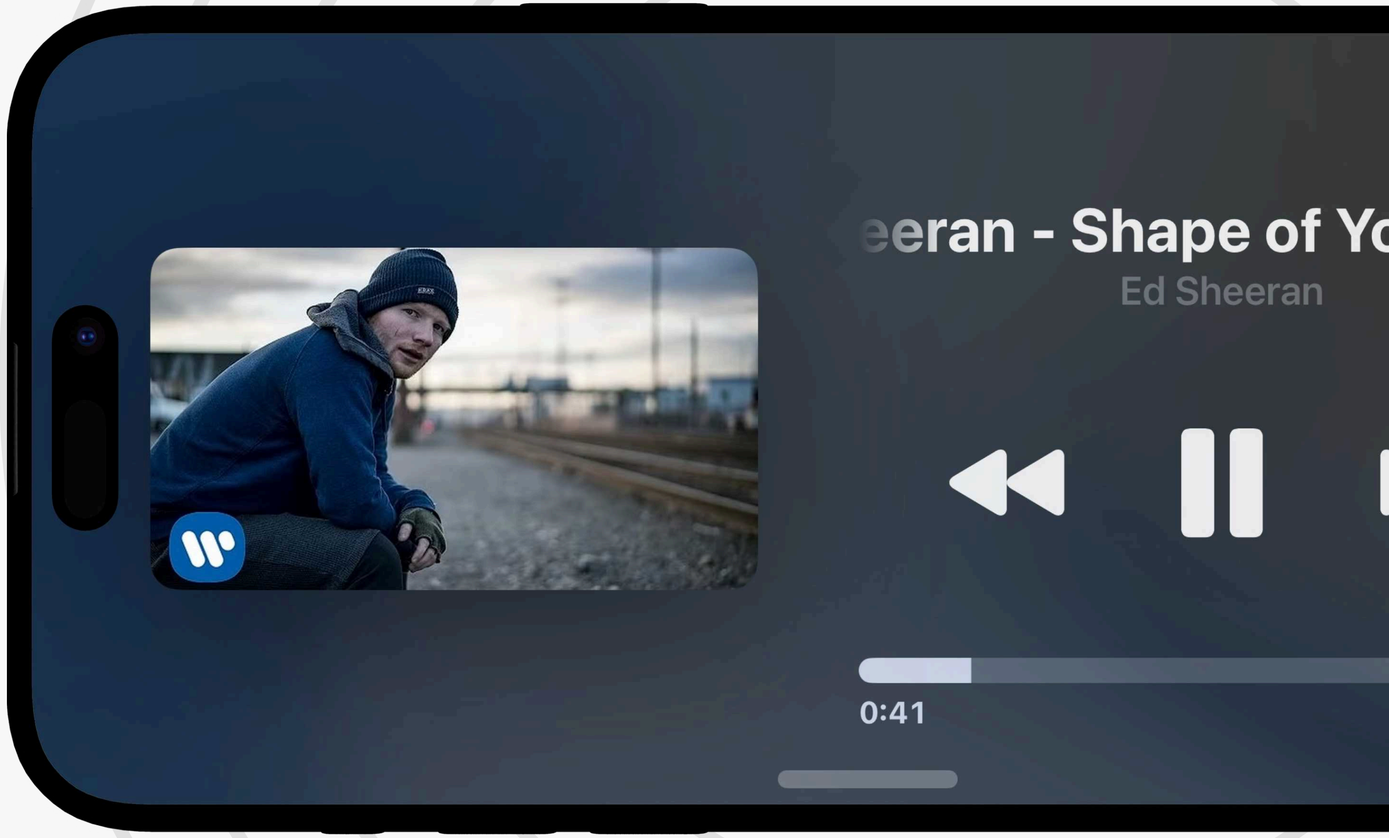
Device used in this research:

iPhone 15 Pro Max

The version used in this research:

iOS 17.6.1

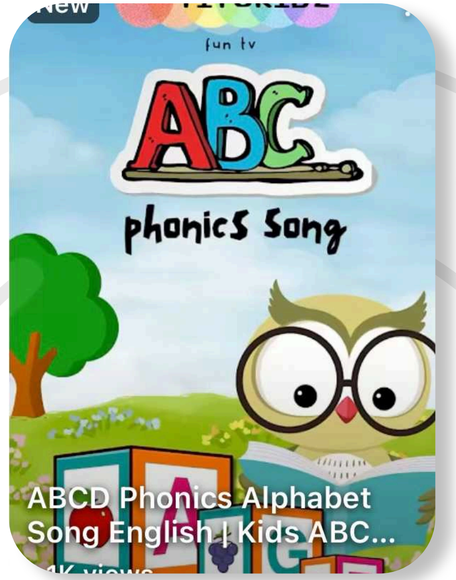
YouTube updates independently with its own version number, separate from iOS updates.

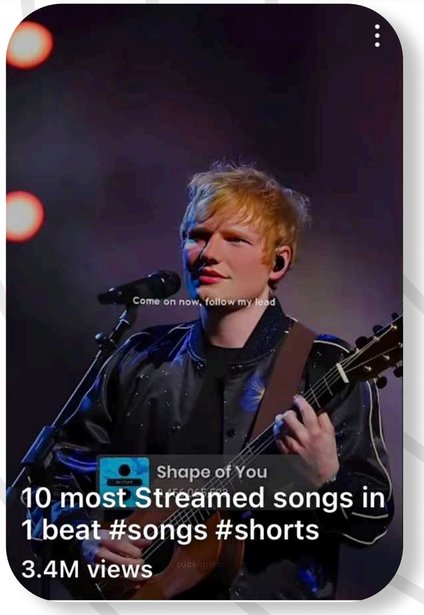


Background

YouTube, developed by **Google LLC**, is a global video-sharing platform designed for users to upload, view, and interact with videos. It offers features such as personalized recommendations, search functionality, user profiles, and interactive elements like likes and comments. Available for free with ads, it also offers a paid subscription, **YouTube Premium**, for an ad-free experience and additional features.

With over **2.5 billion monthly users** and more than **10 billion downloads**, YouTube is a highly influential platform in digital media. It has been chosen for analysis due to its widespread impact and complex UI, which provides insights into effective design practices for engaging large audiences.

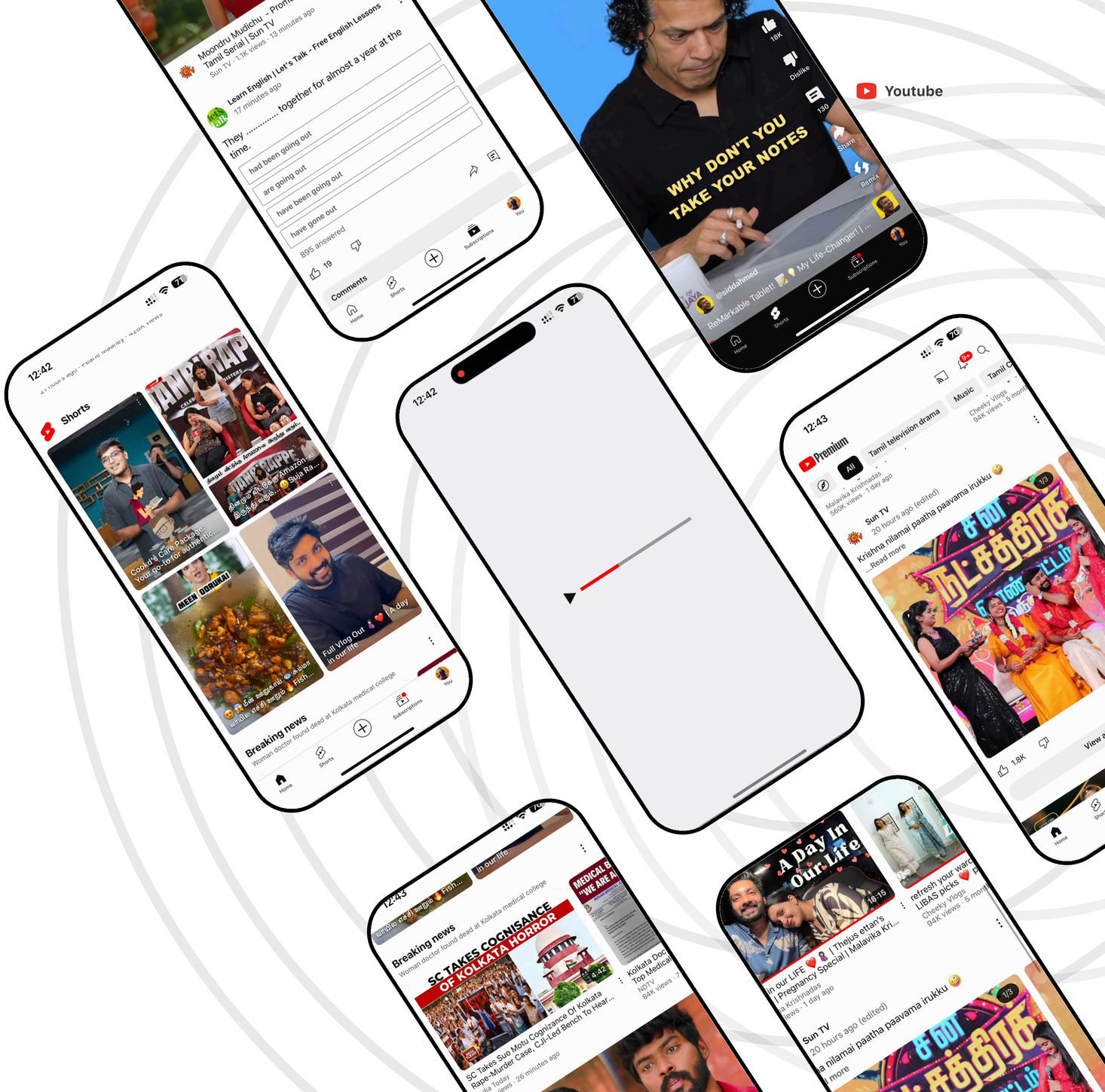




Background

Why Choose Youtube for Analysis?

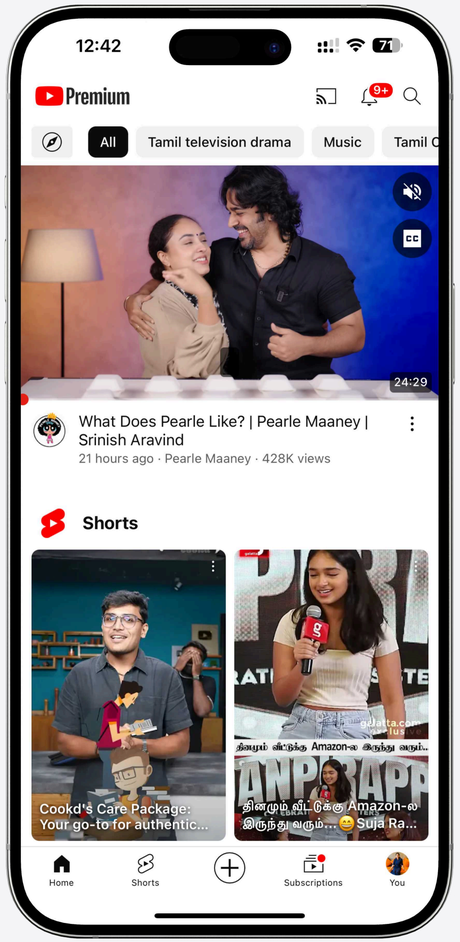
YouTube is a compelling choice for analysis due to its **enormous user base**, its pivotal role in shaping digital content consumption, and its integration with the broader Google ecosystem. With its extensive library and diverse content, YouTube offers valuable insights into user engagement and interaction within a dynamic multimedia environment. By researching YouTube, I aim to explore user behavior, understand the complexities of its UI, and uncover design principles that contribute to its success as a leading platform for video sharing and streaming.



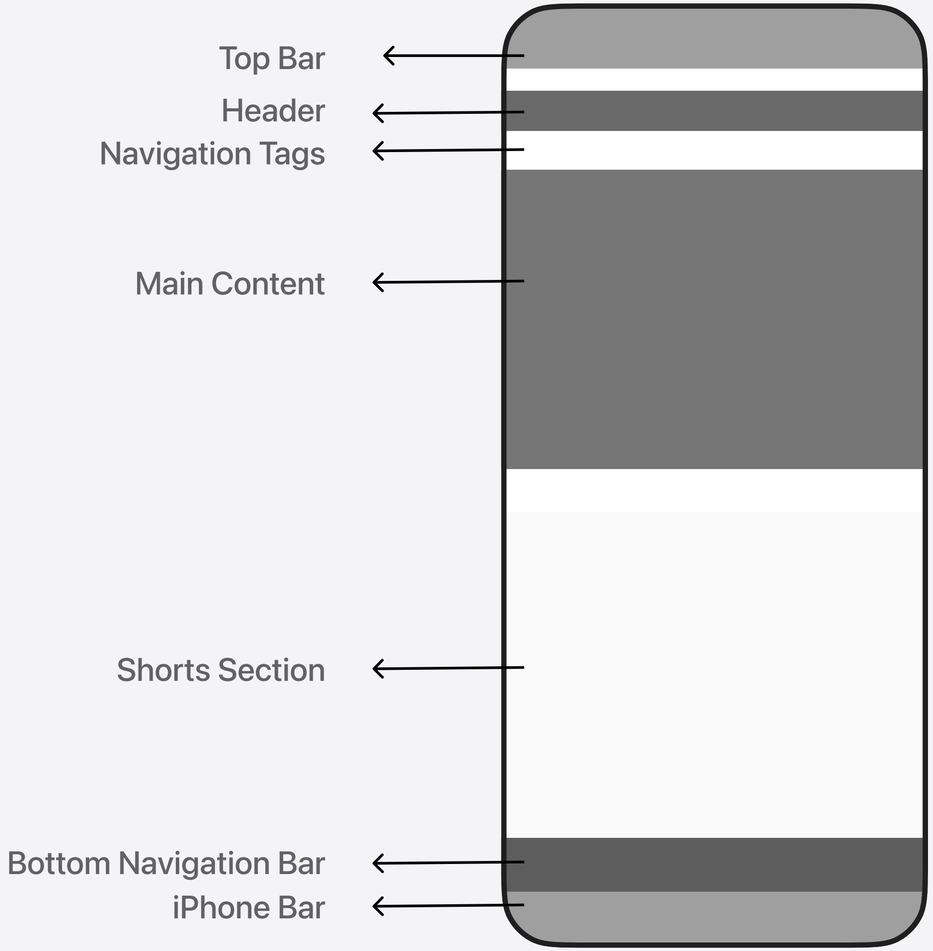
Visual Structure

- Layout
- Hierarchy
- Perception

Layout

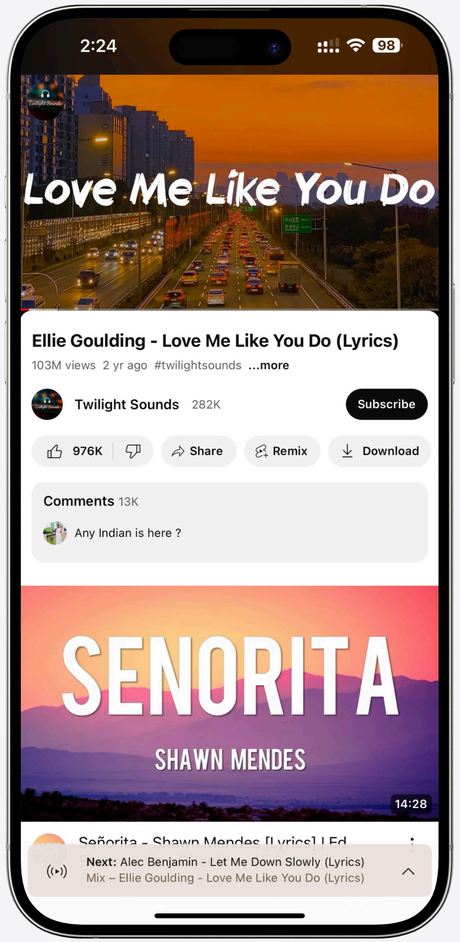


Home Page

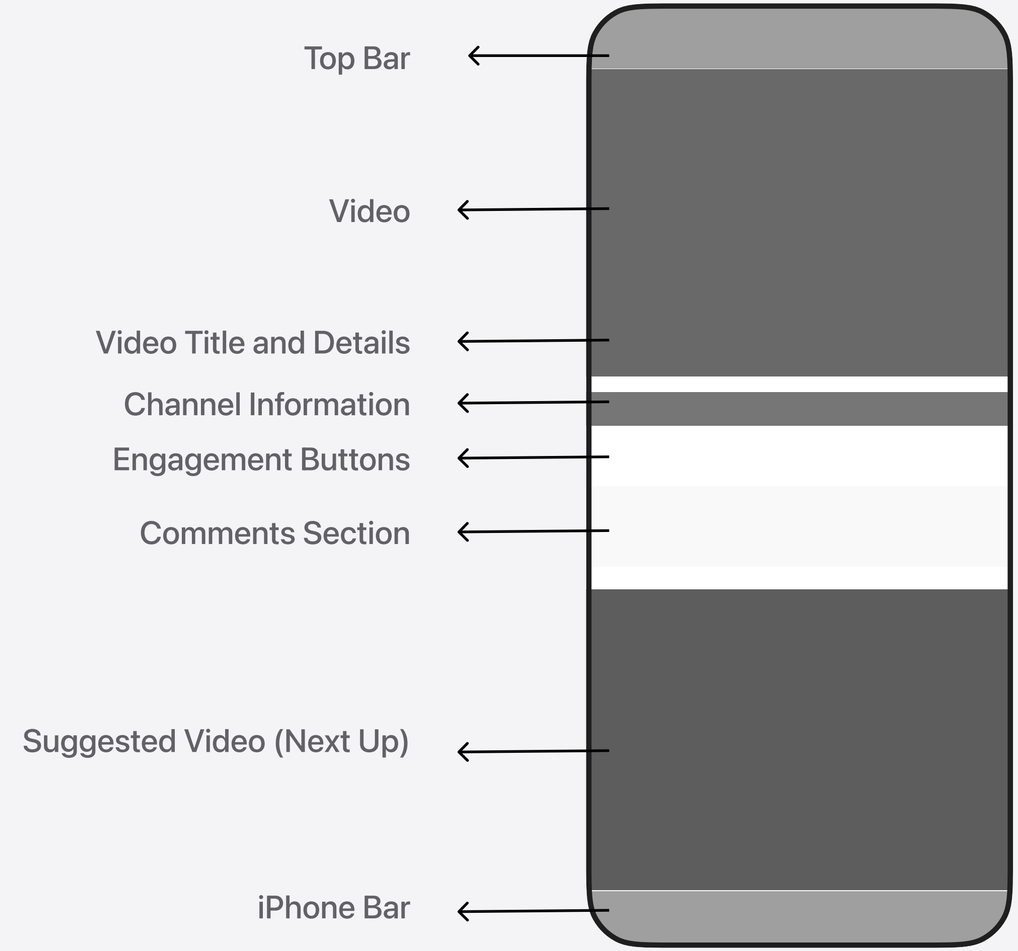


Visual Structure

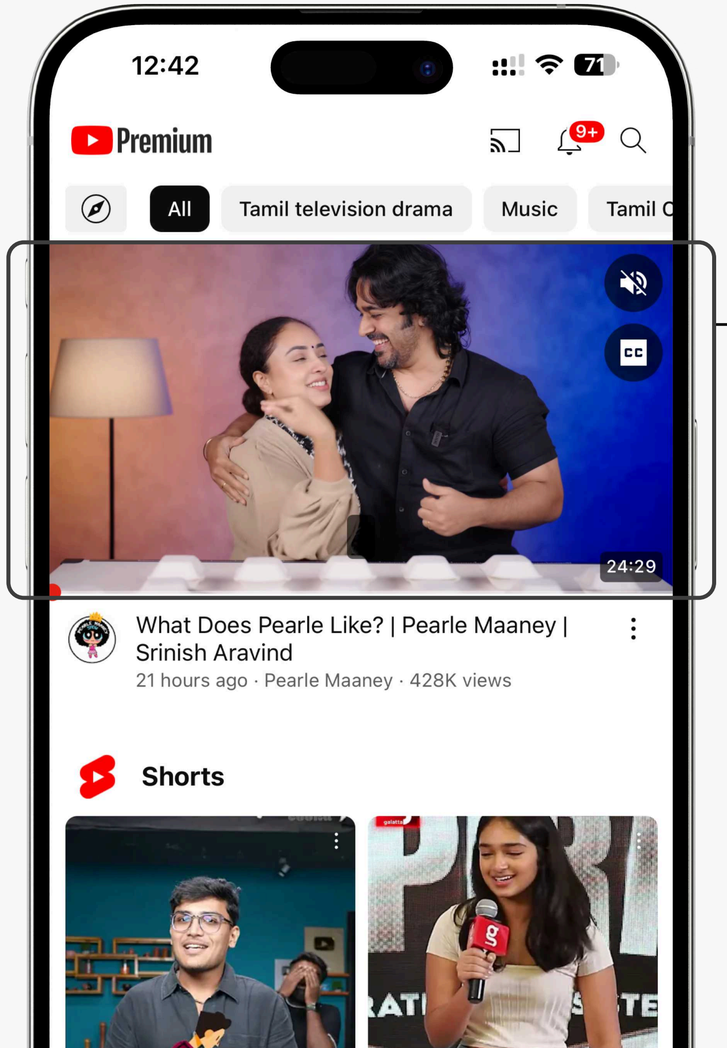
Layout



Video Playing Page



Hierarchy

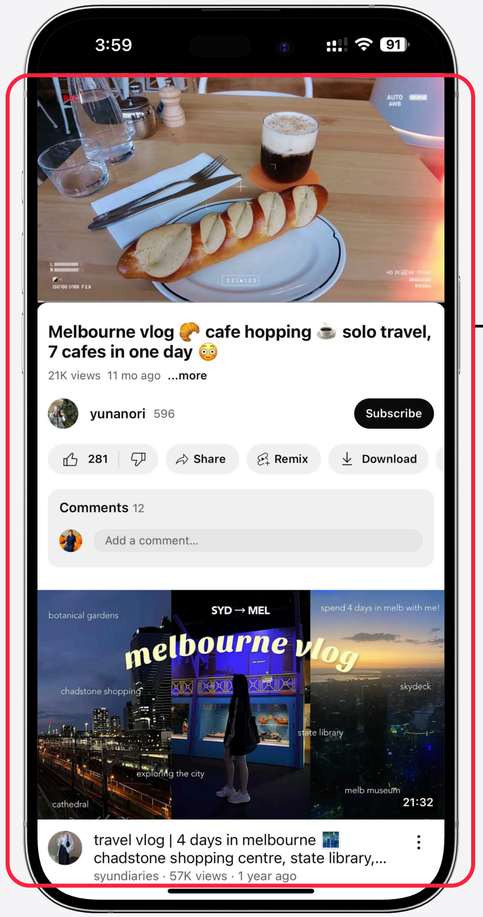


Size

Size On this YouTube page, the video thumbnail takes up a significant portion of the screen's width, making it clear that the video content is the most important information. The large size of the thumbnail draws the user's attention immediately, indicating its priority on the page.

This principle of size is effectively used throughout YouTube's interface, ensuring that the most critical elements, such as video content and playback controls, are prominently displayed. This approach helps users quickly identify and engage with the main content on the page.

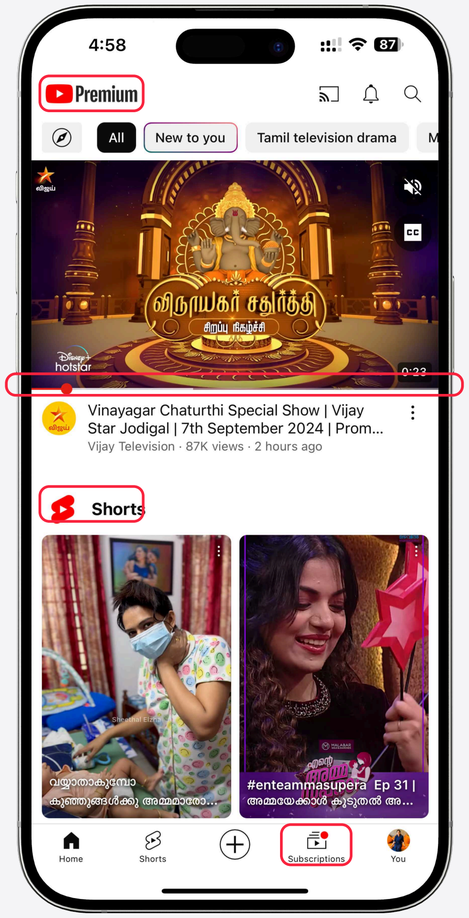
Hierarchy



Alignment

On this YouTube page, the layout is organized with elements aligned in a single column, ensuring a clean and consistent presentation. The video title, channel information, and engagement buttons are neatly aligned below the video thumbnail, creating a structured flow that guides the user's eye down the page. This alignment helps users easily distinguish and interact with related elements, reinforcing the idea that these components are part of the same content experience.

Hierarchy



Color

On this YouTube page, the theme color red is prominently used for important interactive elements, such as the "Subscribe" button and progress bar, making them highly noticeable and engaging. This bold red stands out effectively against both light and dark backgrounds, drawing the user's attention to key actions and reinforcing YouTube's brand identity. The use of red ensures that these interactive elements are easily distinguishable and encourages user interaction.

Perception

Figure/Ground

On this YouTube page, the video thumbnail serves as the primary background, while the content overlay, such as the video title, channel information, and interaction buttons, is displayed prominently on top. The contrast between the background and the overlay is enhanced with clear, **distinct** text and icons, often utilizing a light color against the darker elements of the thumbnail. This figure/ground relationship effectively separates the interactive elements from the background, ensuring that key information is easily readable and visually prioritized.

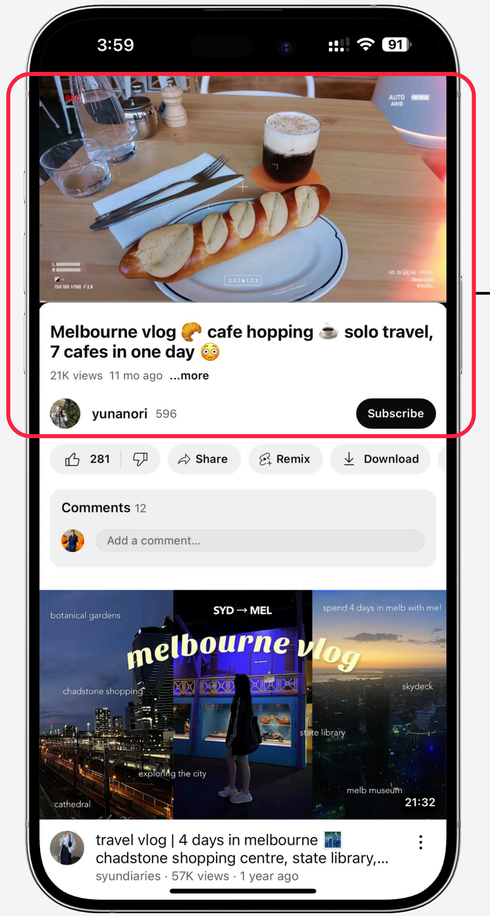
Perception

Similarity

On YouTube, various video categories are consistently arranged in the same size.

The icons and text in the bottom navigation bar are evenly spaced and uniform in design.

Perception



Proximity

On YouTube, textual information such as the video title, channel name, and view count is grouped closely together near the video thumbnail, making it easy for users to quickly access related details without visual clutter.

Youtube

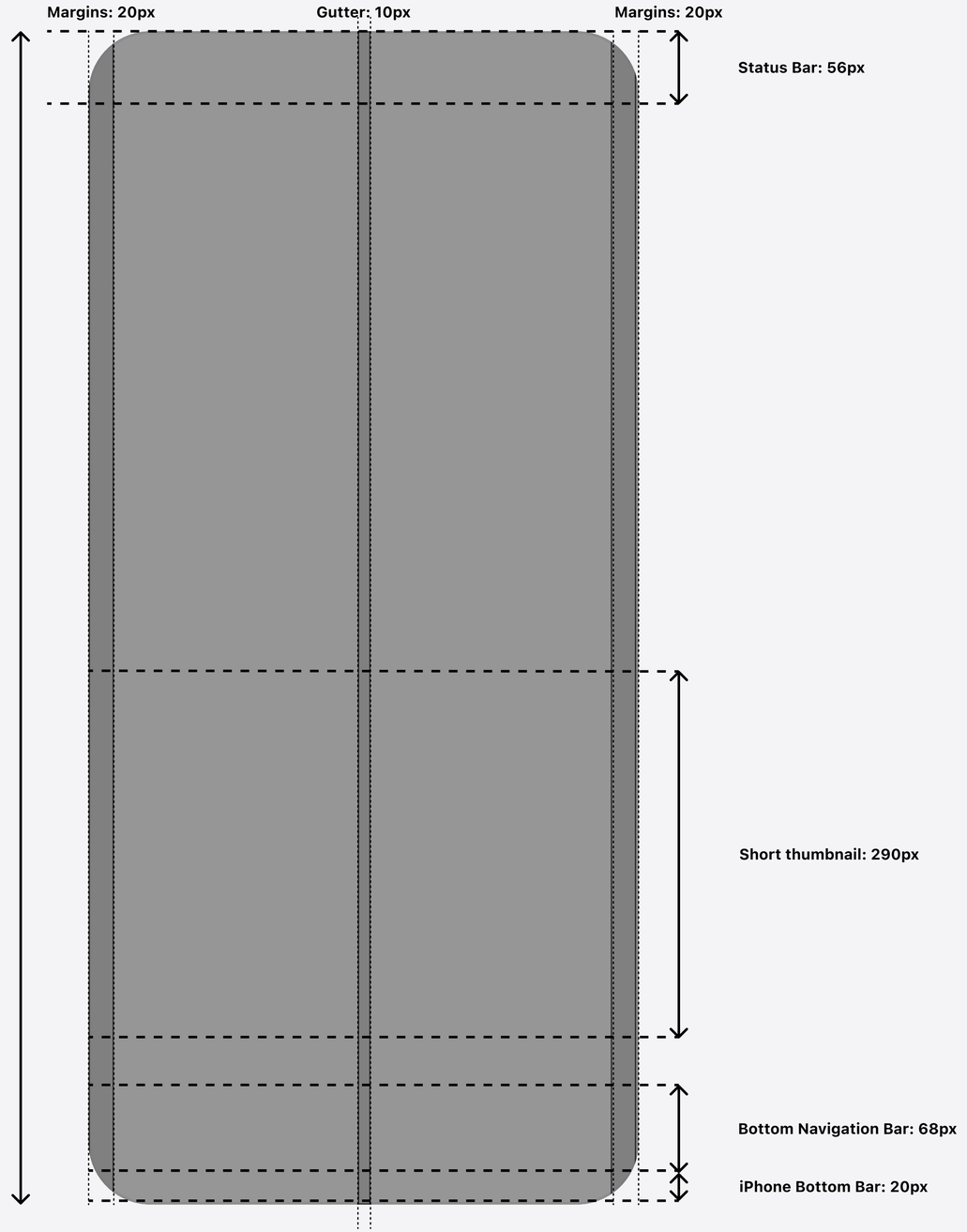
Grids & Spacing

- Grids
- Spacing

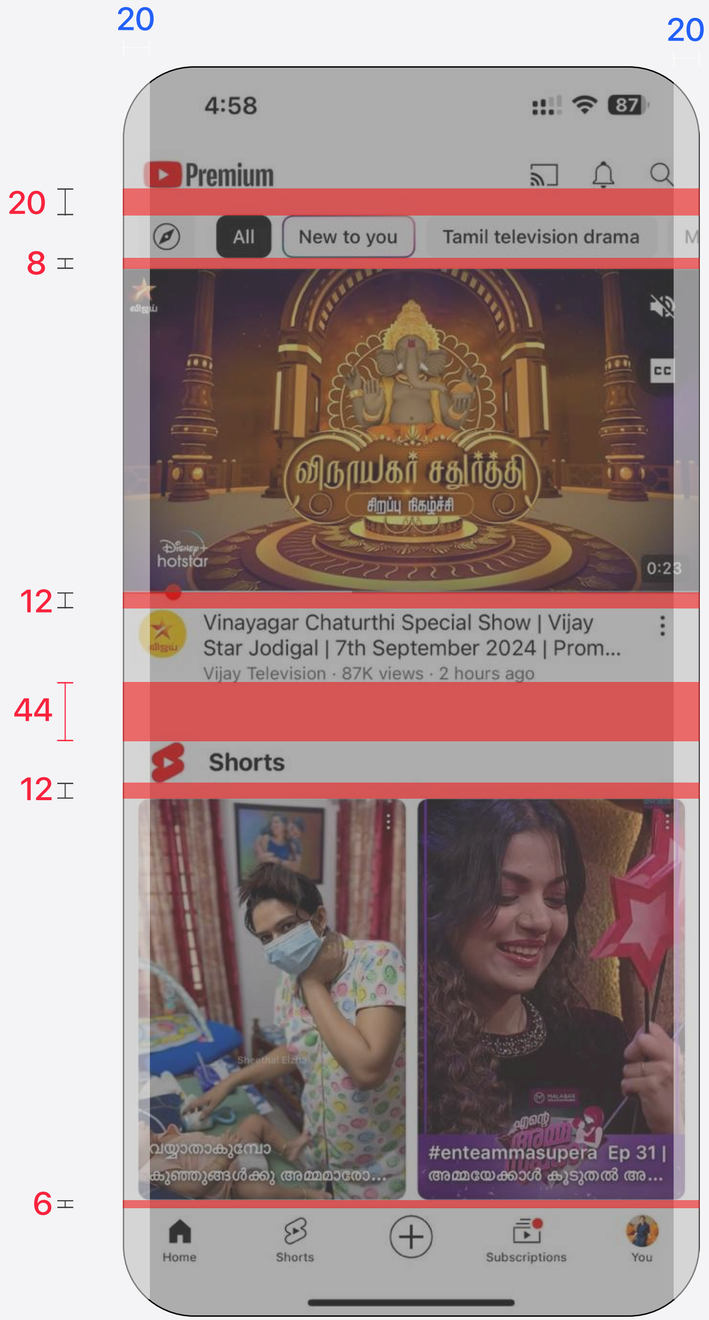
02

Grid

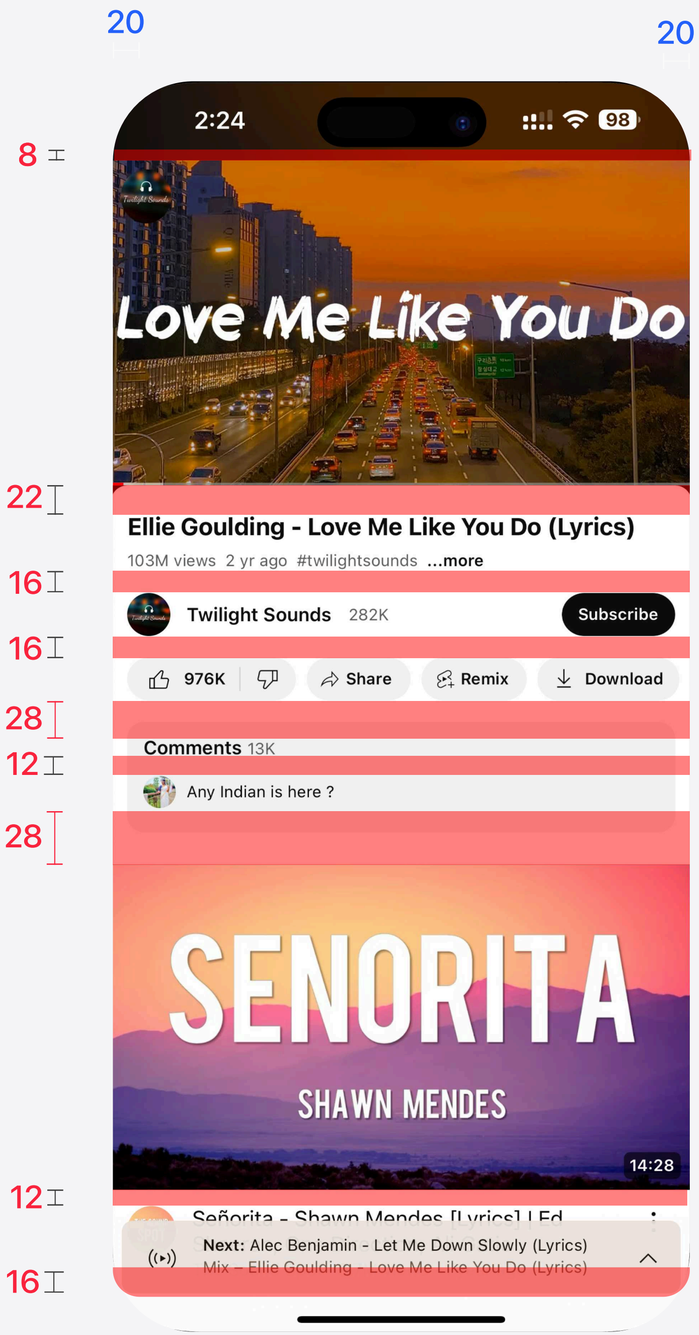
Screen: 430px x 932px



Grid

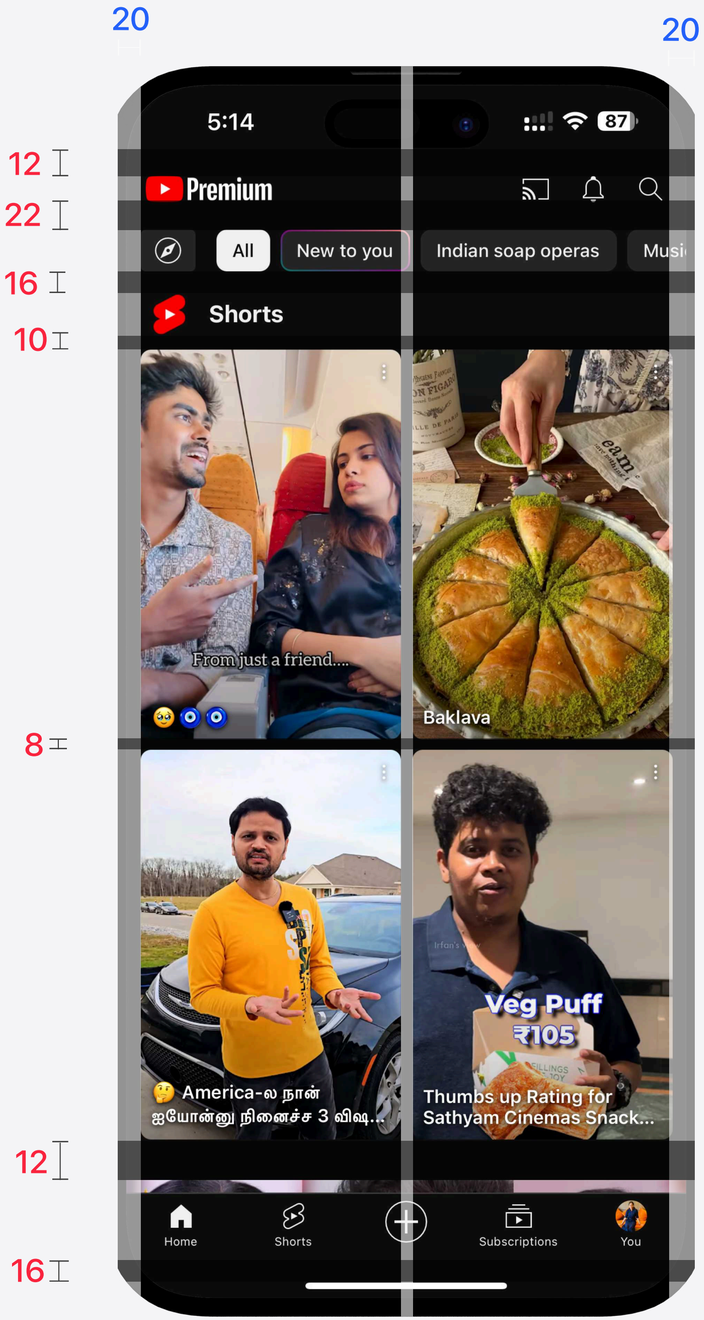

20
20
20
8
12
44
12
6
4:58
87
Premium
All
New to you
Tamil television drama
விருமகர் சதுர்த்தி
சிறப்பு நிகழ்ச்சி
0:28
Vinayagar Chaturthi Special Show | Vijay Star Jodigal | 7th September 2024 | Prom...
Vijay Television · 87K views · 2 hours ago
Shorts
#enteammasupera Ep 31 |
Home
Shorts
Subscriptions
You

Spacing



Youtube

Spacing


20
20
12
22
16
10
8
12
16
5:14
87
Premium
All
New to you
Indian soap operas
Musi
Shorts
From just a friend....
Baklava
America-ல நான்
ஐயோன்னு நினைச்ச 3 விஷ...
Veg Puff
₹105
Thumbs up Rating for
Sathyam Cinemas Snack...
Home
Shorts
Subscriptions
You

Typography

- Typefaces
- Type Scale
- Type in Use

Typography

Roboto

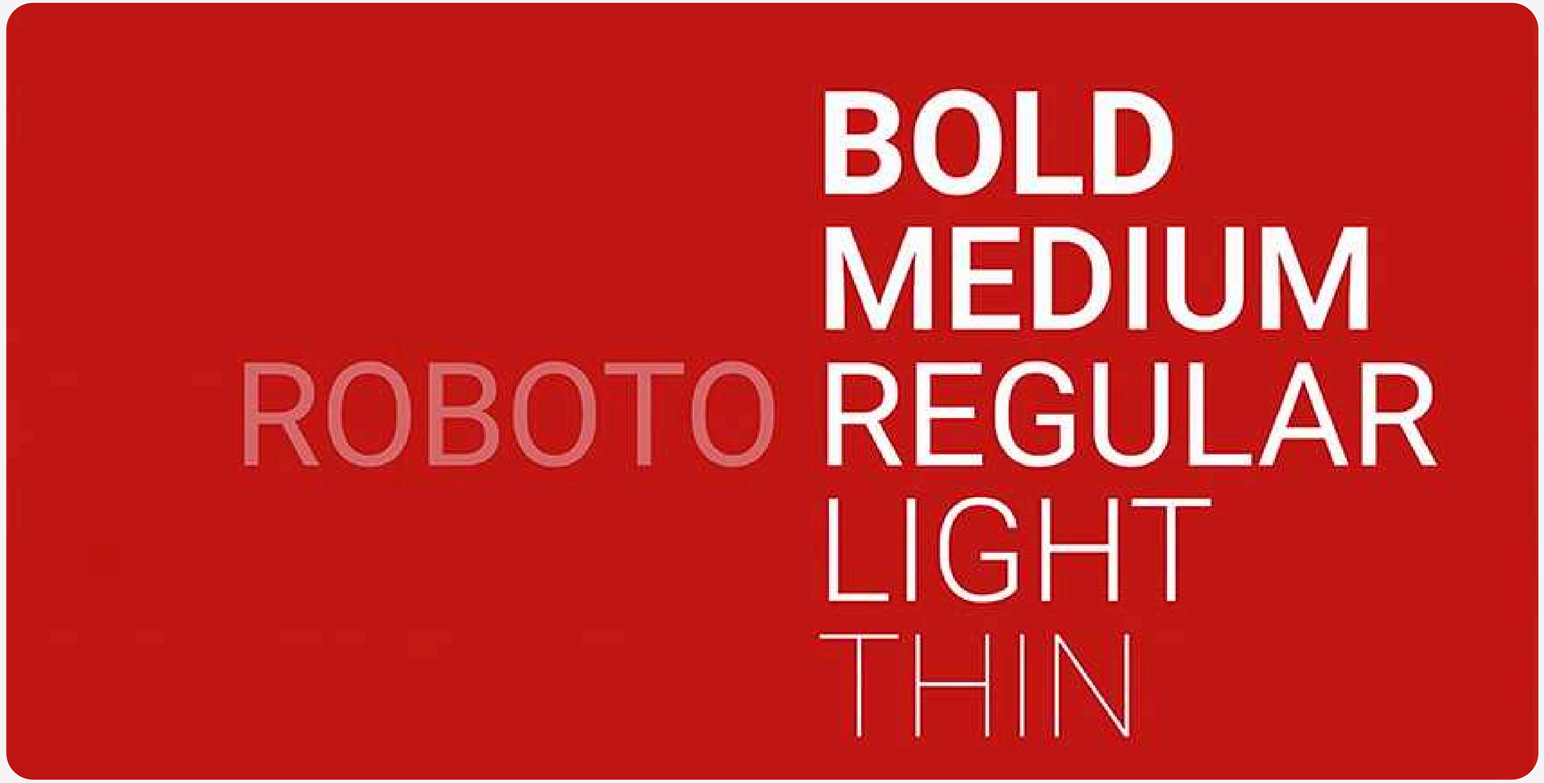
In Youtube, a font named **Roboto** is used with three different weights: Roboto Regular, Roboto Medium, and Roboto Bold.

Roboto Regular	Roboto Medium	Roboto Bold
ABCDEF GHIJKLM NOPQRST UVWXYZ	ABCDEF GHIJKLM NOPQRST UVWXYZ	ABCDEF GHIJKLM NOPQRST UVWXYZ
abcdefgh ijklmnopqr stuvwxyz	abcdefgh ijklmnopqr stuvwxyz	abcdefgh ijklmnopqr stuvwxyz
0123456789	0123456789	0123456789

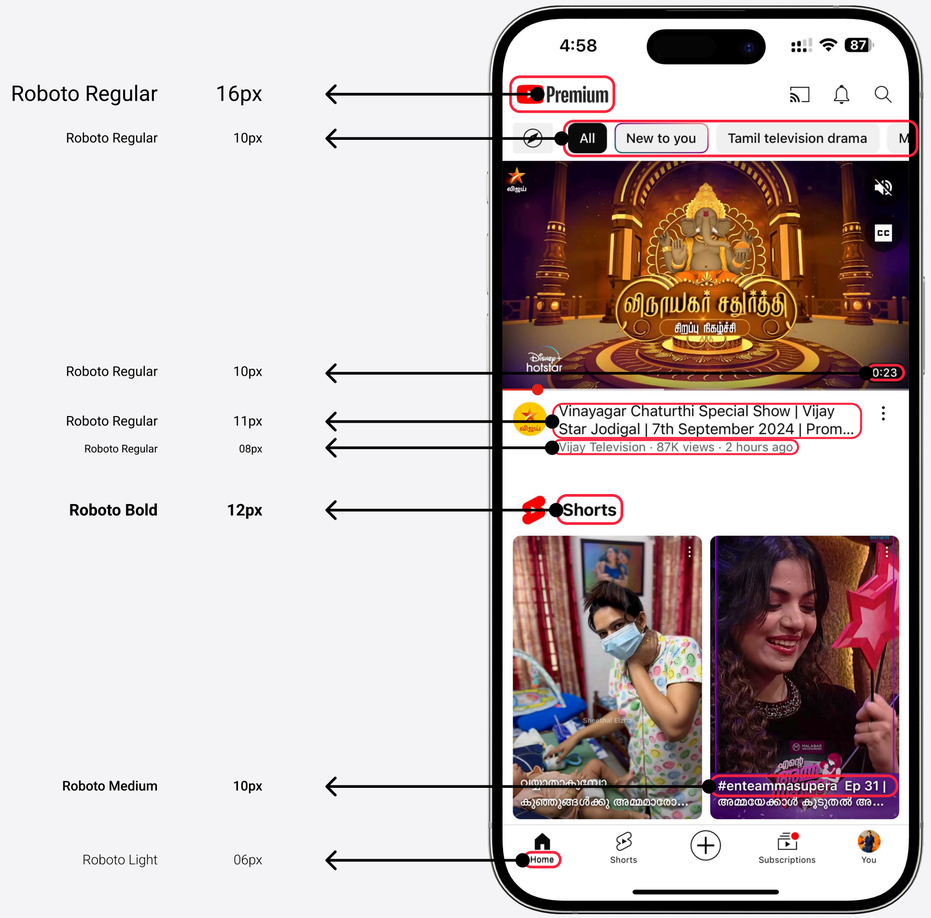
Typography

Roboto

Roboto is a modern sans-serif typeface created by Google for digital interfaces, including Android and YouTube. Designed with geometric shapes and open curves, it ensures readability on various screen sizes. Roboto's flexible weights and **optimized** character spacing make it ideal for both body text and headings, providing clarity across different devices. It is a key font in Google's Material Design system, known for its balance of modernity and legibility.

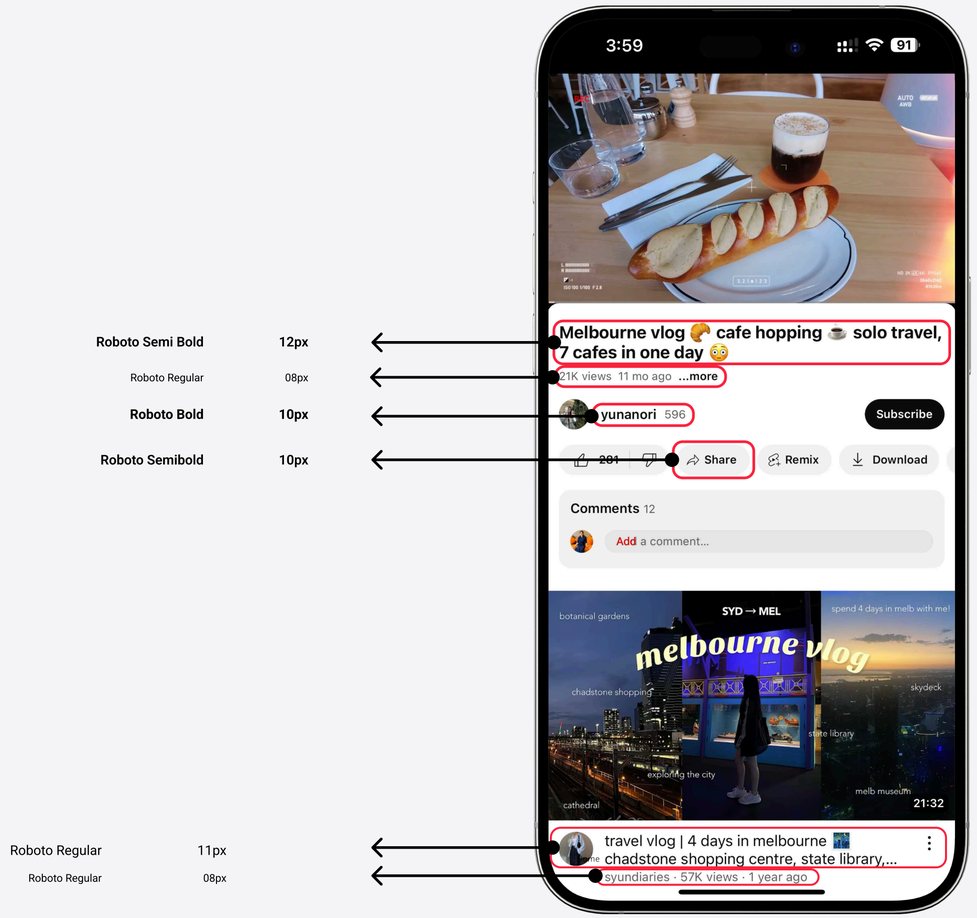


Type Scale



Home Page

Type Scale



Video playing Page

Typography in Use

Roboto

YouTube uses the Roboto typeface in various weights and sizes to create a clear visual hierarchy. Titles are typically in **Bold (34px)**, headlines in **Medium (20px)**, and body text in **Regular (16px)**. This structure ensures readability and consistency across different sections of the platform, with slight adjustments in letter spacing to enhance clarity.

Scale Category	Typeface	Weight	Size	Case	Letter spacing
Title 1	Roboto	Bold	34	sentence	0.4
Title 2	Roboto	Bold	24	sentence	0.2
Headline	Roboto	Medium	20	sentence	0
Body	Roboto	Regular	16	sentence	0
Subhead	Roboto	Medium	16	sentence	0
Footnote	Roboto	Regular	12	sentence	0

Colour

- Palette
- Rules & accessibility
- Colour in Use

Palette

Light mode

YouTube’s light mode palette uses white for the background, red for key elements, and black for text, with neutral gray for metadata. This clean and simple design enhances readability and maintains brand consistency.
4o

Background colour

Primary White
CMYK 0 / 0 / 0 / 0
HEX #FFFFFF
RGB 255 255 255
HSL 0, 0%, 1%
LAB 100, 0.01, -0.01

Light gray
CMYK: 0 / 0 / 0 / 9
HEX: #E8E8E8
RGB: 232 232 232
HSL: 0, 0%, 91%
LAB: 92, 0, -0.01

Red
CMYK: 0 / 86 / 76 / 2
HEX: #FF0000
RGB: 255 0 0
HSL: 0, 100%, 50%
LAB: 53.86, 76.11, 43.49

Text colour

Black
CMYK: 0 / 0 / 0 / 100
HEX: #000000
RGB: 0 0 0
HSL: 0, 0%, 0%
LAB: 0, 0, 0

Neutral gray
CMYK: 2 / 2 / 0 / 45
HEX: #8A8A8D
RGB: 138 138 141
HSL: 240, 0.01%, 55%
LAB: 57.56, 0.6, -1.61

Palette

Dark mode

YouTube’s dark mode palette features a dark gray background with white text for readability. Red is used for key elements like buttons, maintaining brand identity, while lighter gray is used for secondary text, ensuring clear contrast and a comfortable viewing experience in low-light settings.

Background colour

Primary Black
CMYK: 0 / 0 / 0 / 100
HEX: #000000
RGB: 0 0 0
HSL: 0, 0%, 0%
LAB: 0, 0, 0

Dark Gray
CMYK: 0 / 0 / 0 / 75
HEX: #121212
RGB: 18 18 18
HSL: 0, 0%, 7%
LAB: 7.4, 0, 0

Red
CMYK: 0 / 86 / 76 / 2
HEX: #FF0000
RGB: 255 0 0
HSL: 0, 100%, 50%
LAB: 53.86, 76.11, 43.49

Text colour

White
CMYK: 0 / 0 / 0 / 0
HEX: #FFFFFF
RGB: 255 255 255
HSL: 0, 0%, 100%
LAB: 100, 0, 0

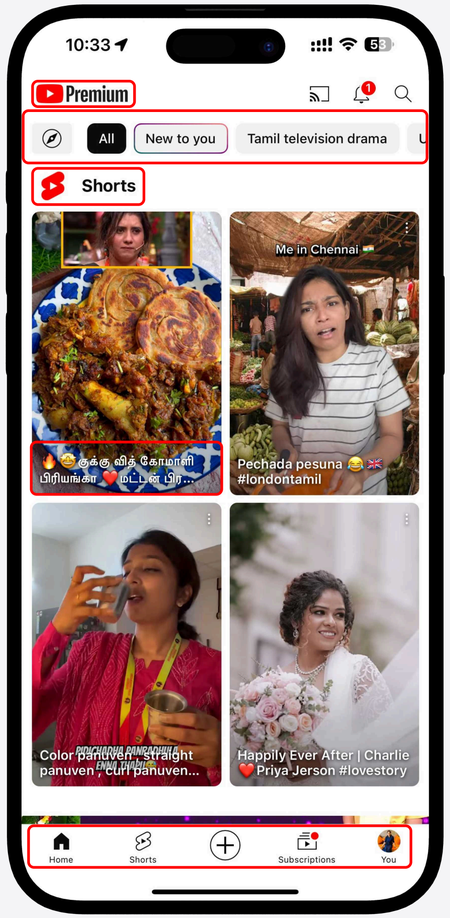
Neutral gray
CMYK: 2 / 2 / 0 / 45
HEX: #8A8A8D
RGB: 138 138 141
HSL: 240, 0.01%, 55%
LAB: 57.56, 0.6, -1.61

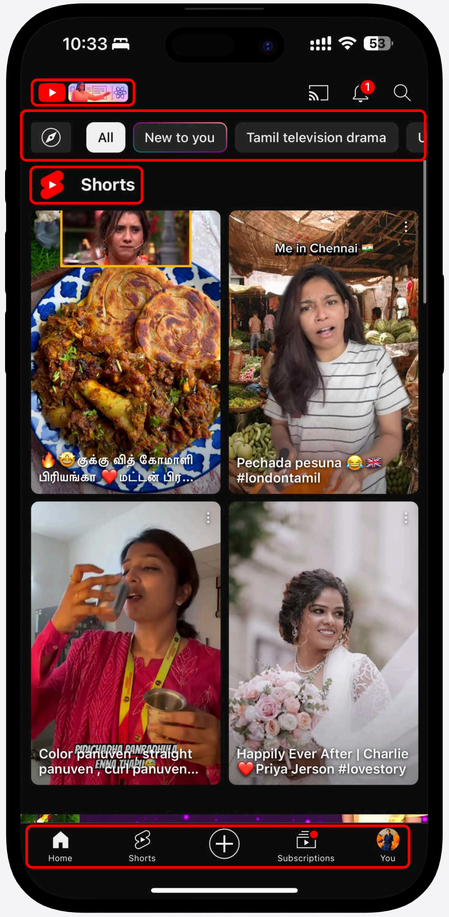
Rules & Accessibility

High Contrast

Light Mode: Black text on a white background provides a clear, easy-to-read interface, minimizing eye strain in bright environments.

Dark Mode: White text on dark gray/black backgrounds reduces glare and eye strain, making it ideal for low-light environments while maintaining high contrast for readability.

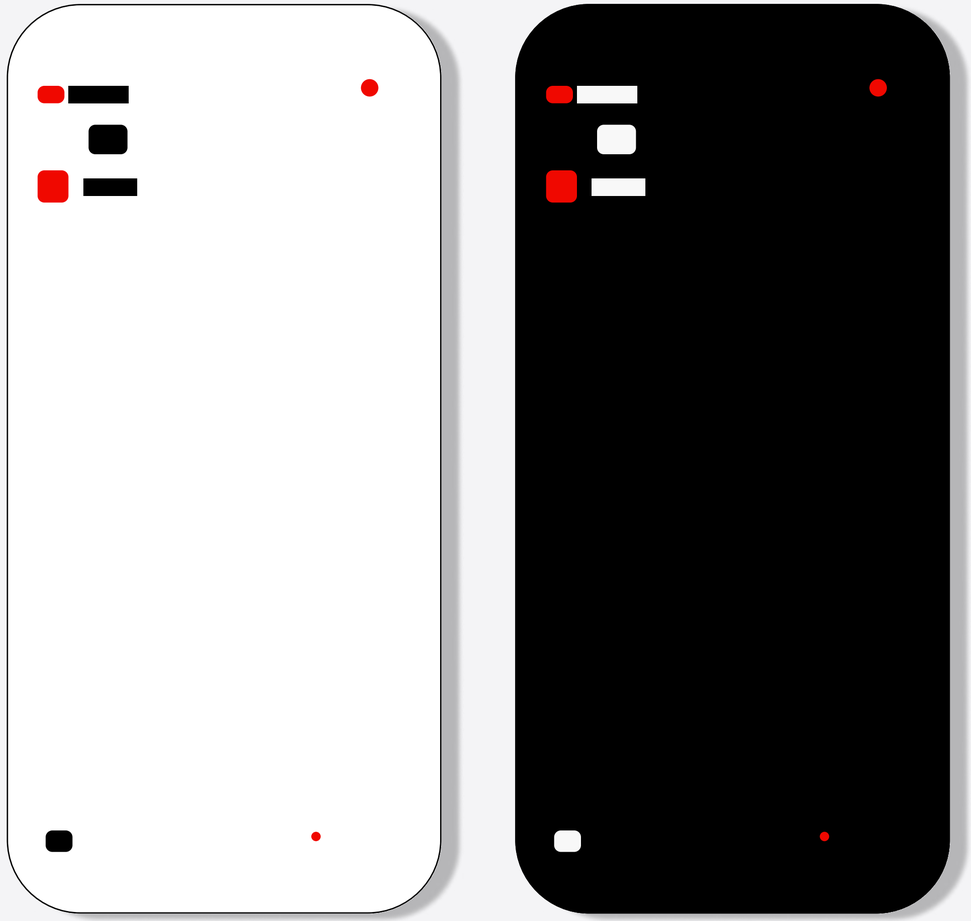




Rules & Accessibility

Color Accessibility

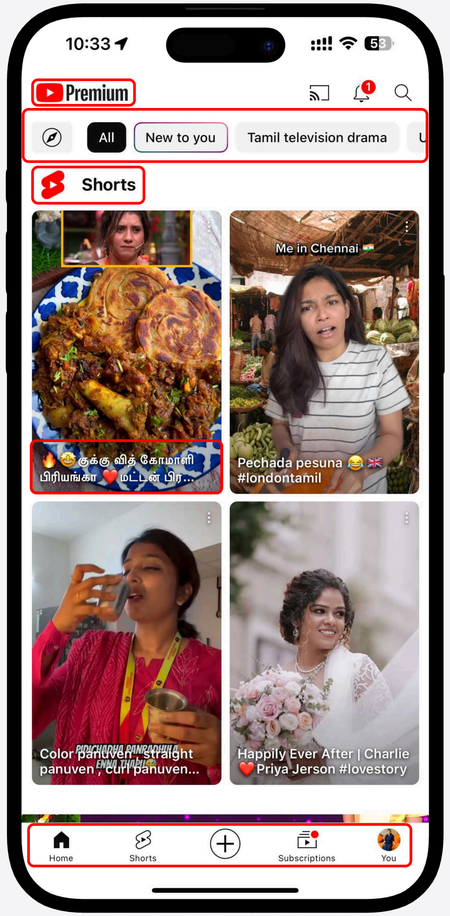
Colors like YouTube's signature red and various grays are chosen to be **color-blind friendly**, ensuring that information is not reliant on color alone for interpretation in both light and dark modes.

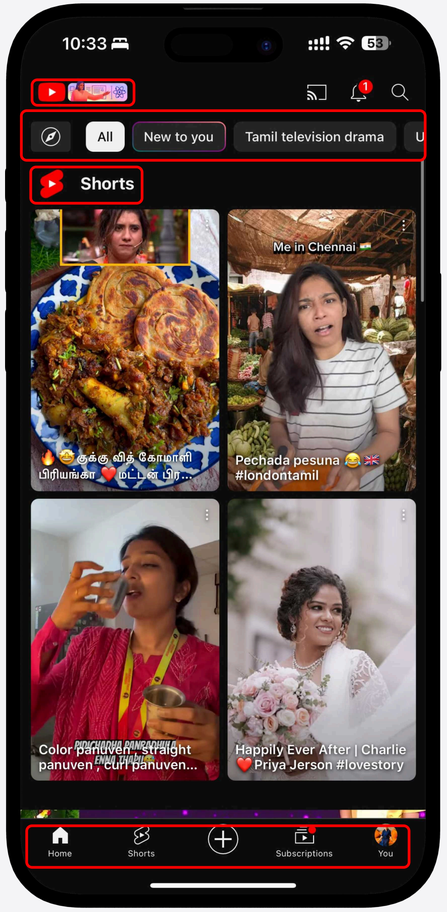


Rules & Accessibility

Legible Fonts

The **Roboto** typeface is used consistently across both modes, with optimized font sizes and weights for titles, body text, and metadata. This ensures clear hierarchy and readability for all users.

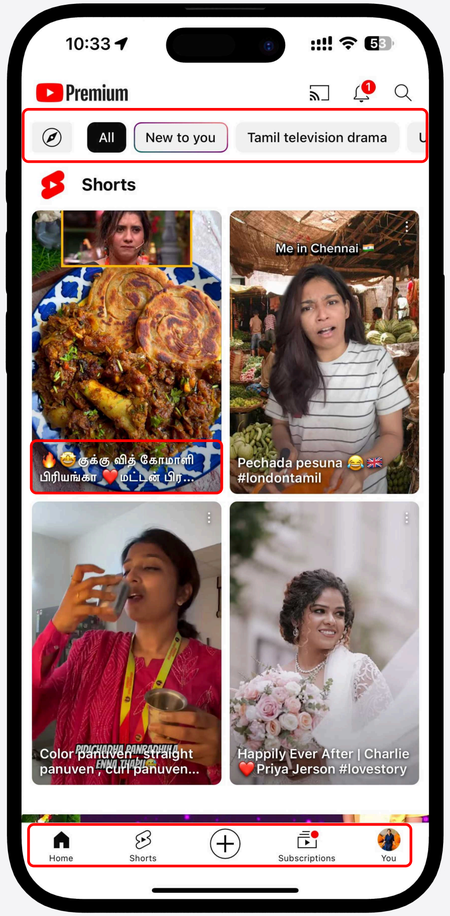


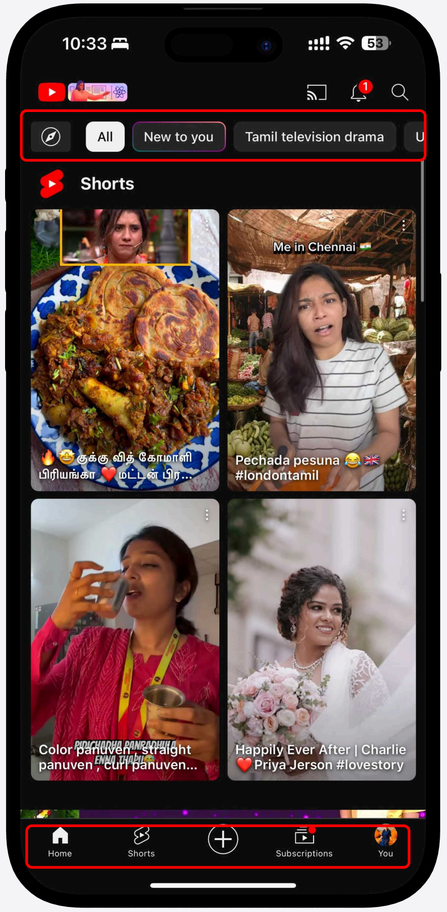


Rules & Accessibility

Focus & Navigation

In both modes, clear focus indicators make it easier for users navigating via keyboard, enhancing accessibility for those with mobility impairments. Touch targets and interactive elements remain consistent, ensuring smooth navigation.

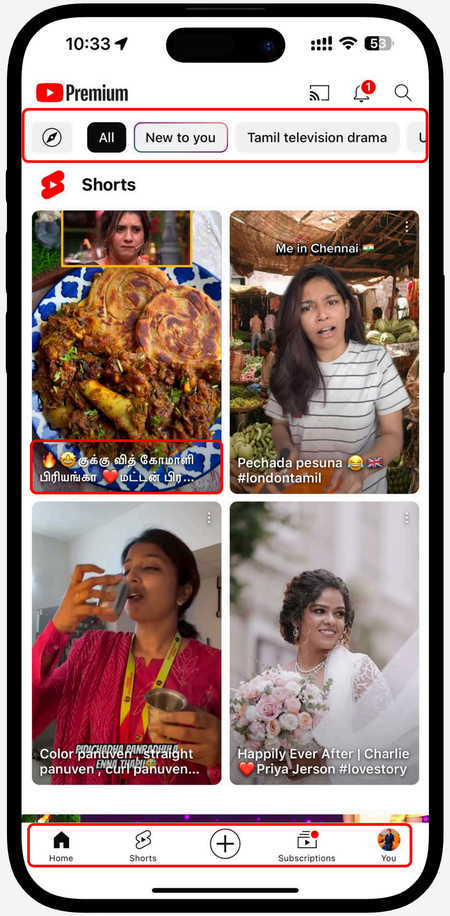


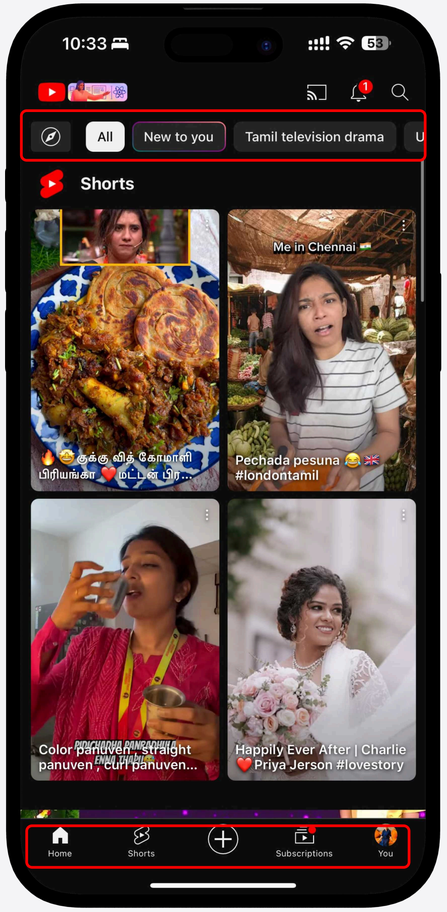


Rules & Accessibility

Touch Targets

Buttons and icons maintain a sufficient size in both modes, ensuring they are easy to tap or click. This meets accessibility standards for touch interfaces, helping users interact effectively regardless of screen brightness or color scheme.

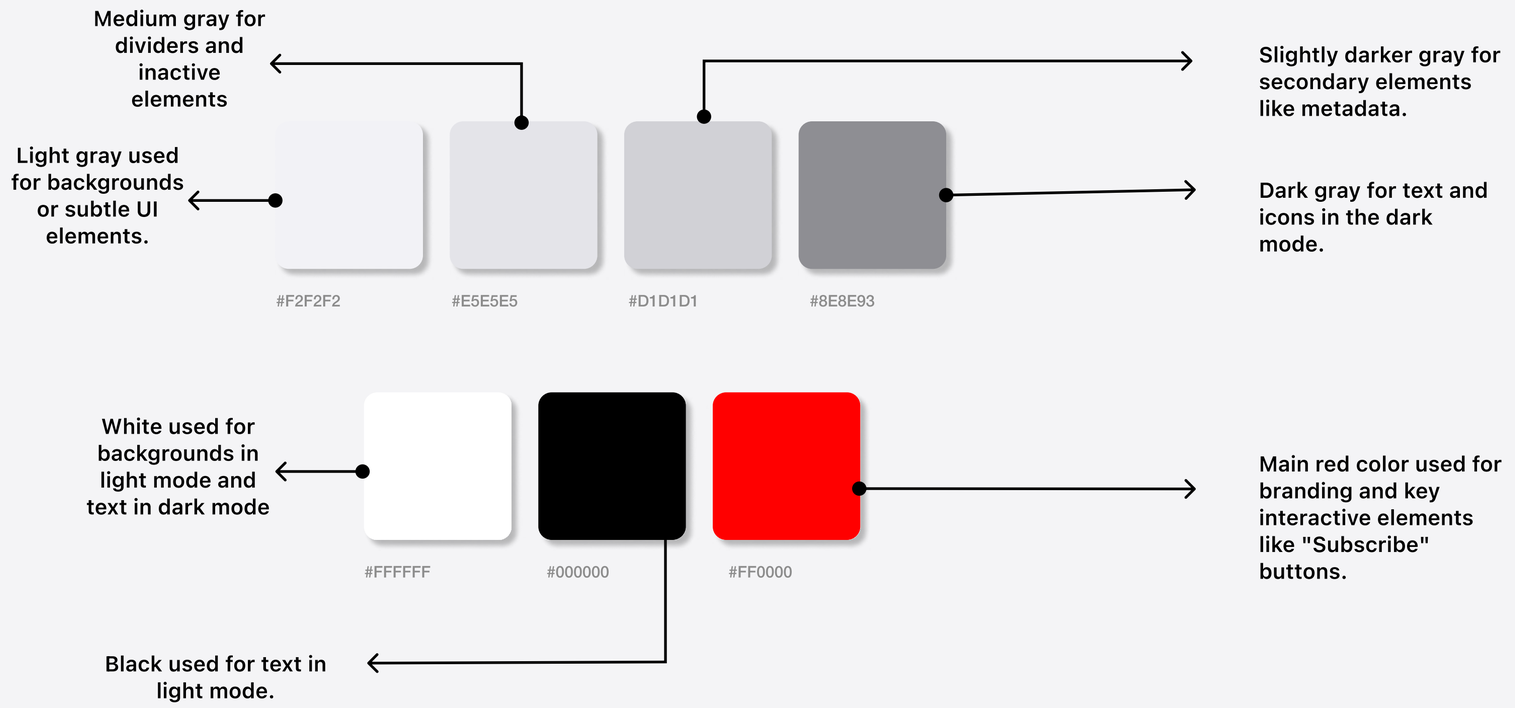




Colour in Use

Gray

These colors maintain YouTube's clean, accessible, and brand-consistent interface across both light and dark modes.



Navigation

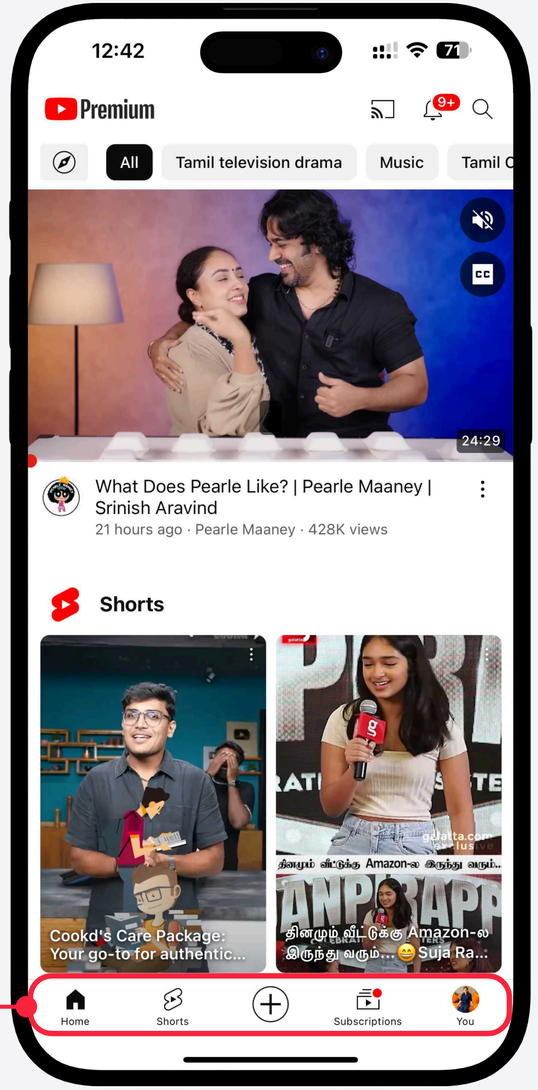
- Navigation Systems
- Flow diagram

Navigation Systems

Global navigation

YouTube's Bottom Navigation Bar provides direct access to 5 main sections: Home, Shorts, Subscriptions, Library, and Create (upload). This bar allows users to easily navigate between key areas of the app.

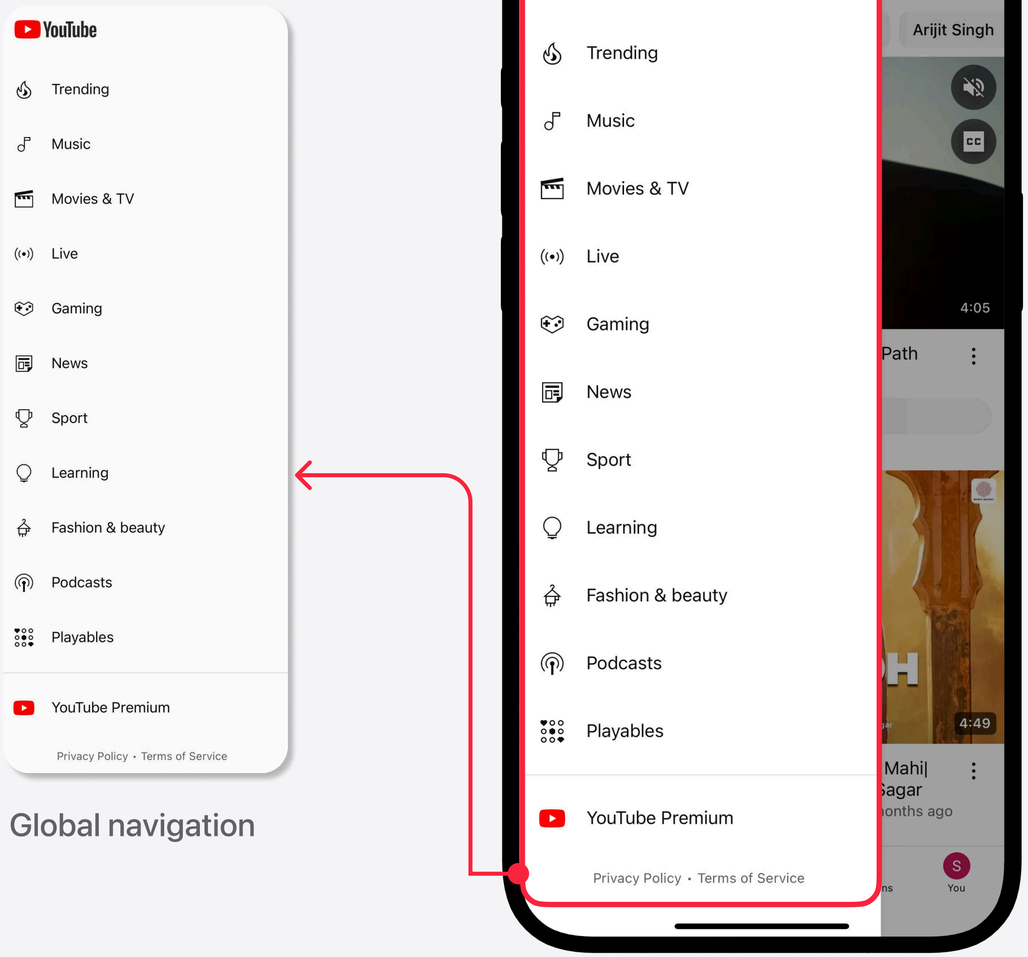
Global navigation



Navigation Systems

Global navigation

The YouTube Sidebar Navigation Menu provides quick access to various content categories like Trending, Music, Movies & TV, Live, Gaming, News, Sport, and more. It allows users to explore different sections of the platform easily, enhancing user experience and navigation.

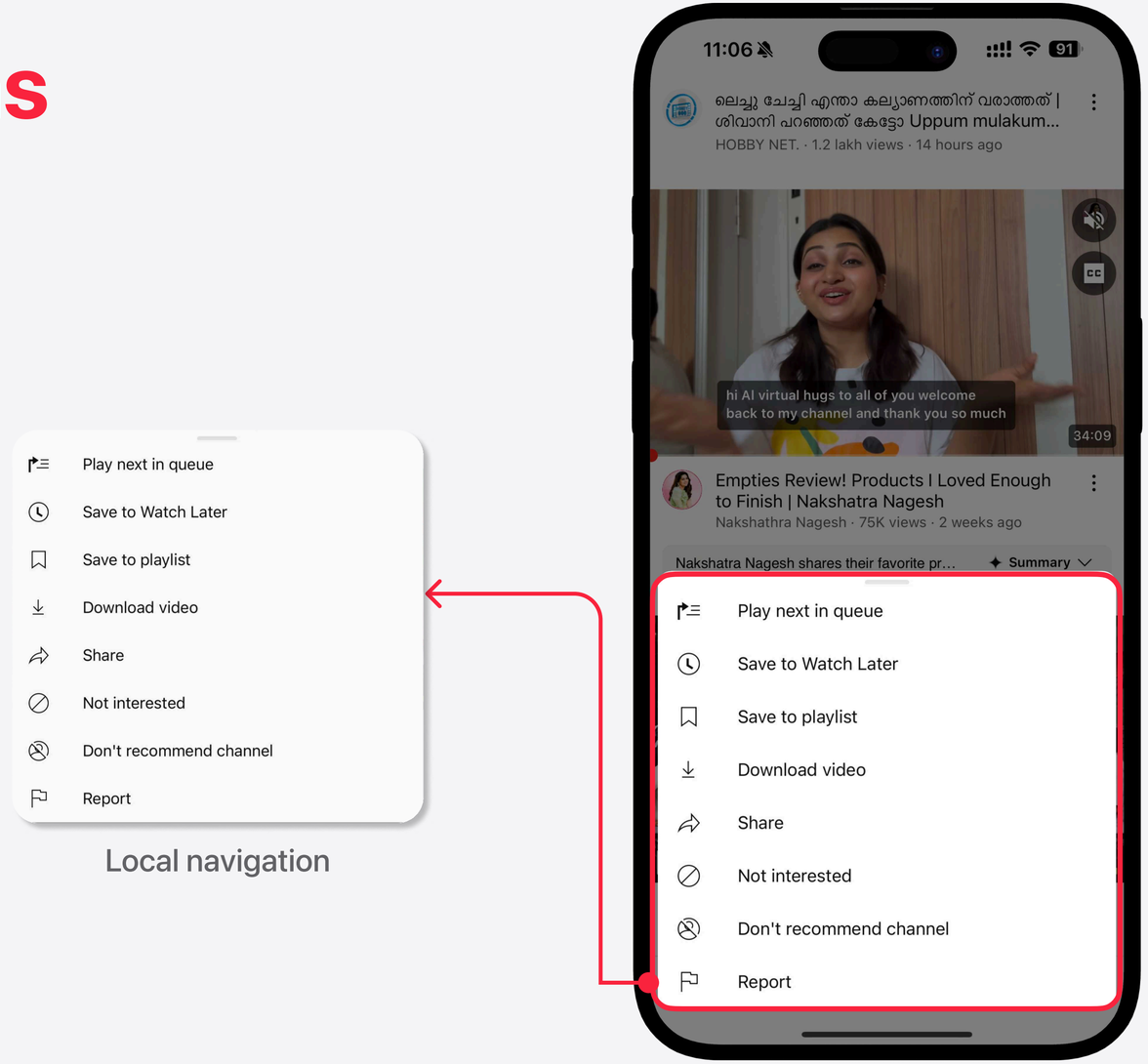


Global navigation

Navigation Systems

Local navigation

YouTube's Bottom Navigation Bar provides direct access to 5 main sections: Home, Shorts, Subscriptions, Library, and Create (upload). This bar allows users to easily navigate between key areas of the app.

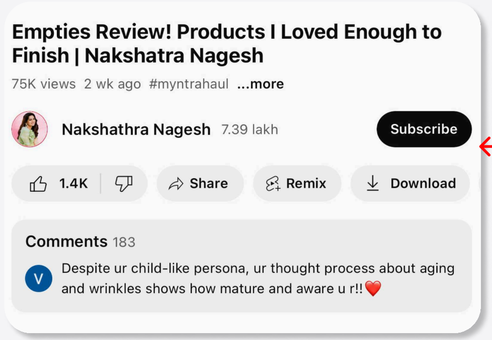


Local navigation

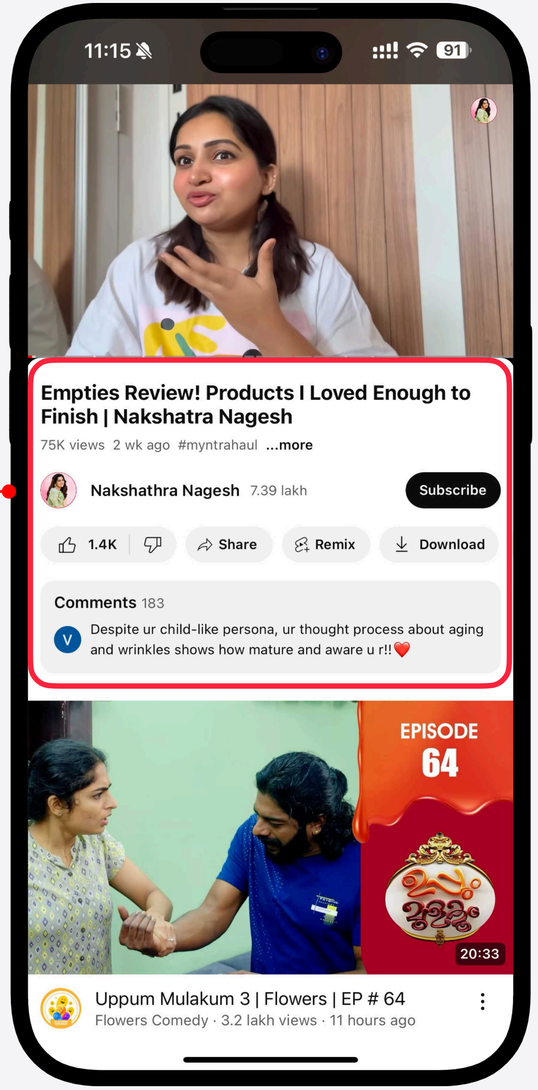
Navigation Systems

Contextual navigation

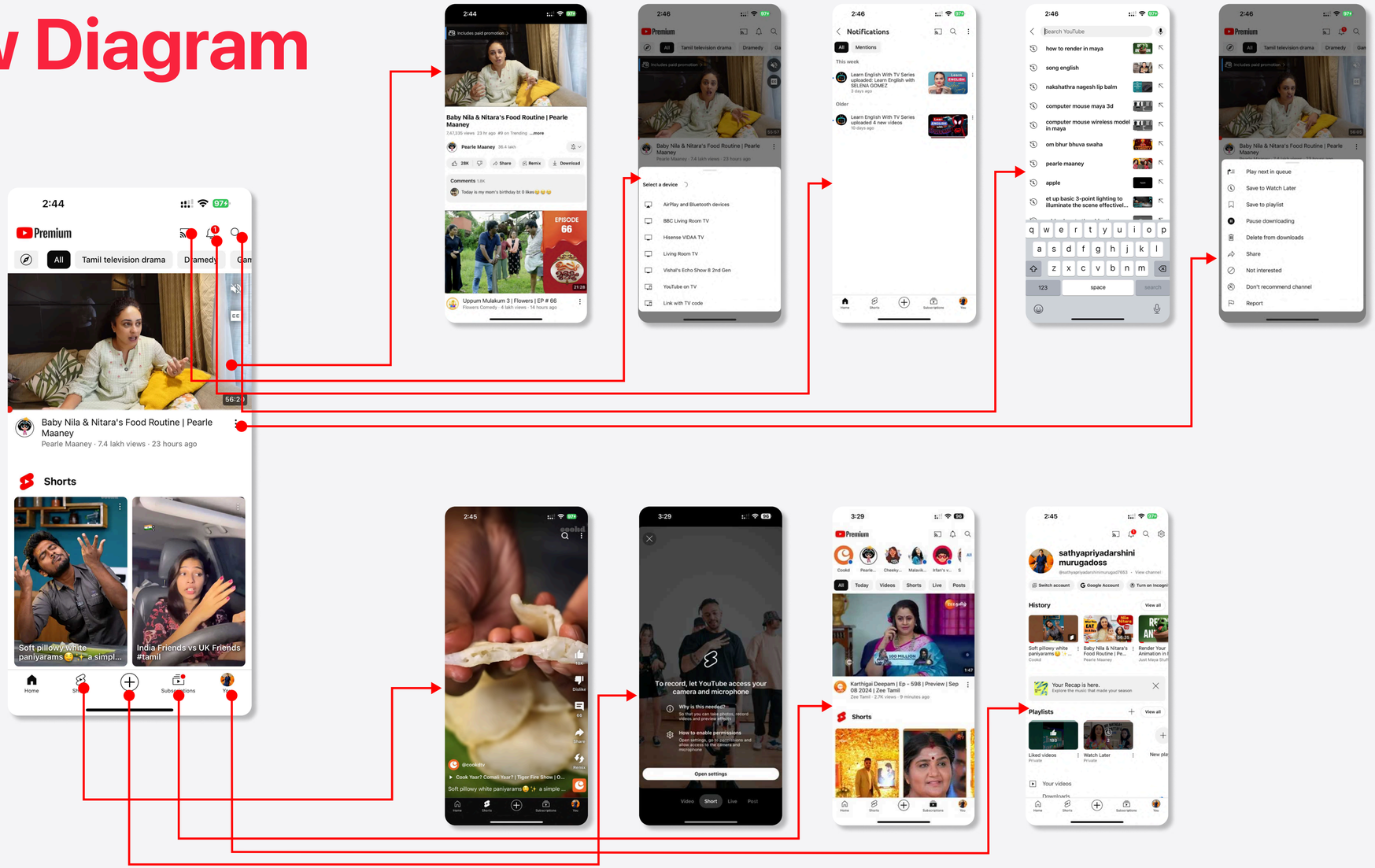
YouTube's Bottom Navigation Bar provides direct access to 5 main sections: Home, Shorts, Subscriptions, Library, and Create (upload). This bar allows users to easily navigate between key areas of the app.



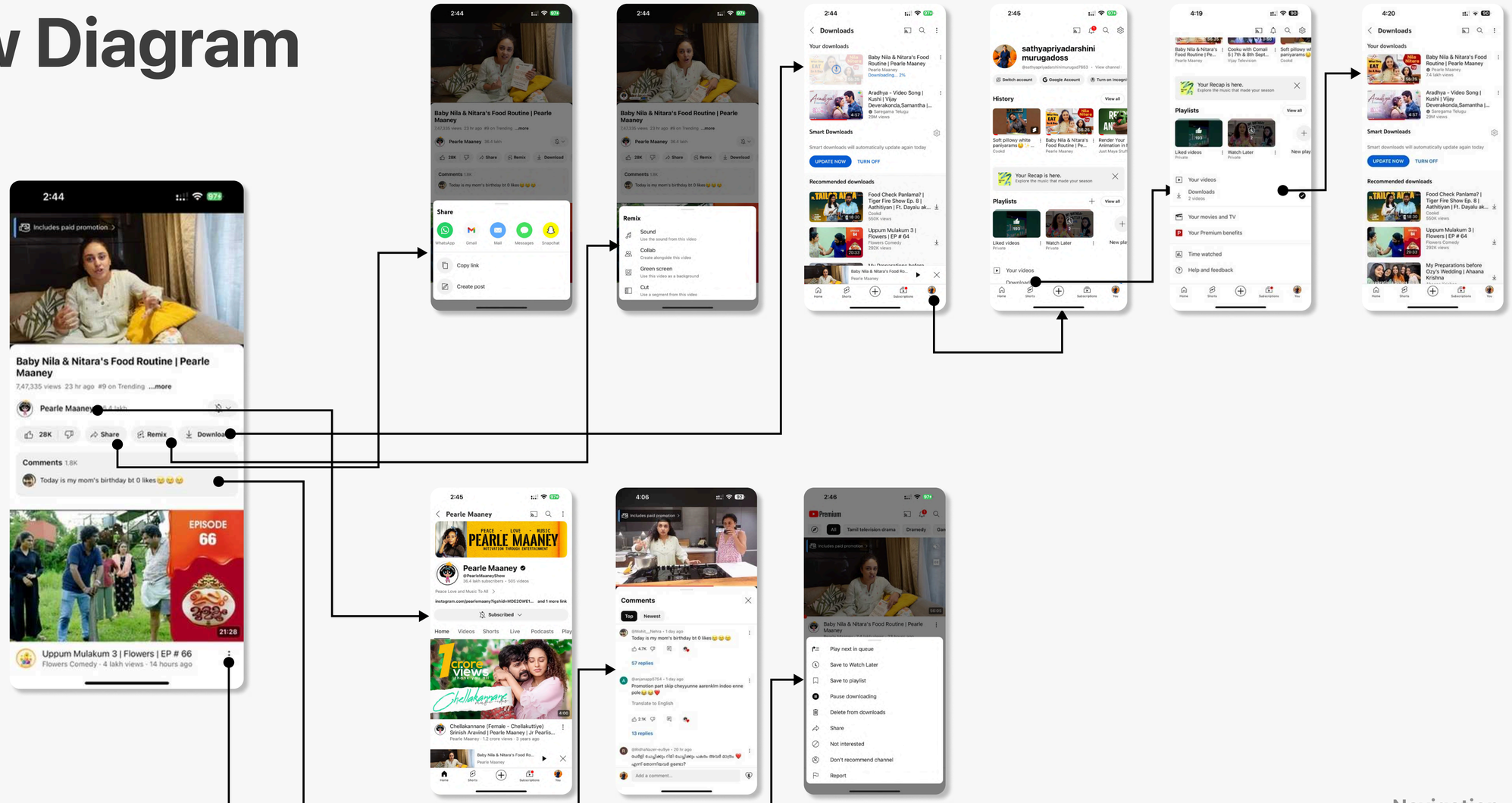
Contextual navigation



Flow Diagram



Flow Diagram



Youtube

UI Elements

- Components
- Patterns

06

Components

Home Page

The **Home Page** is the landing screen that shows personalized video recommendations based on the user's watch history, subscriptions, and trending content. It includes categories like **Trending**, **Recommended for You**, and sometimes **Shorts**. Users can scroll to discover new videos, channels, and playlists tailored to their preferences.

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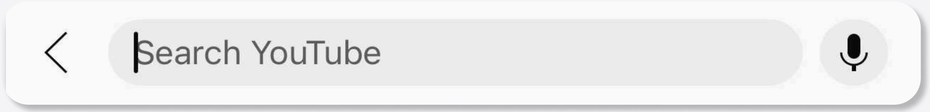
Components

Search Bar

Located at the top of the interface, the **Search Bar** allows users to find specific videos, channels, and playlists by typing in keywords or phrases. It includes auto-suggestions and filters to narrow down results.



Components

Video Player

The **Video Player** is the core of YouTube's experience, featuring controls like play/pause, volume adjustment, quality settings, captions, playback speed, and fullscreen mode. Below the video, users can see details such as the **video title**, **channel name**, and **view count**.

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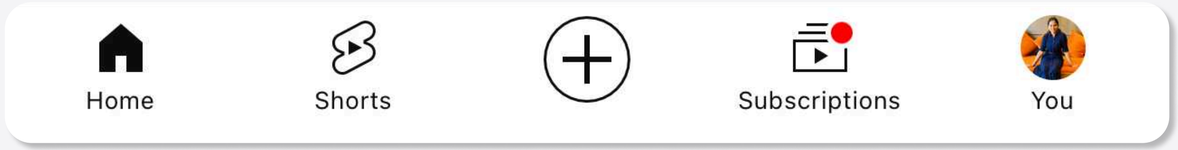
Components

Navigation Bar

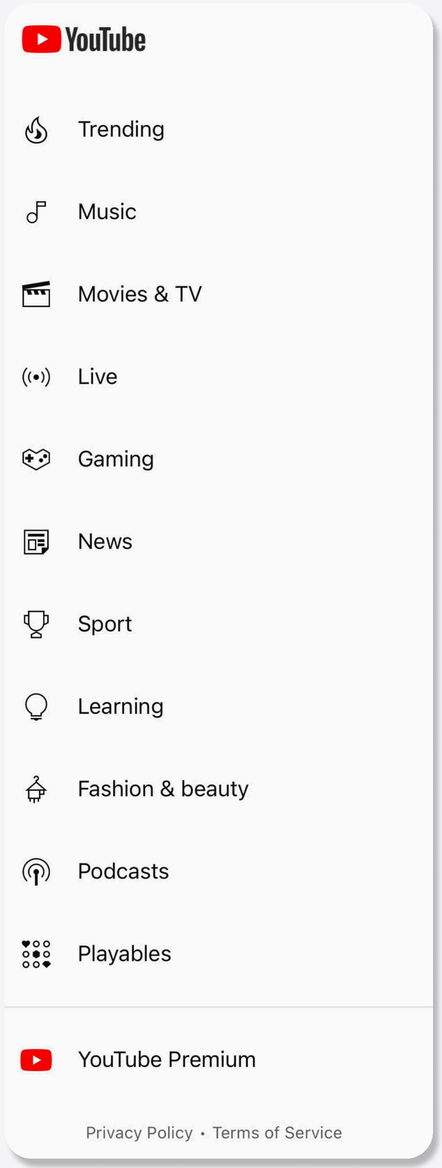
The Bottom Navigation Bar includes five main sections for quick access:

- **Home**: Personalized feed of video recommendations.
- **Shorts**: A vertical video section similar to TikTok.
- **Subscriptions**: Displays new videos from subscribed channels.
- **Library**: Offers access to playlists, history, and saved videos.
- **Create**: Button to upload videos or go live.



Sidebar Menu

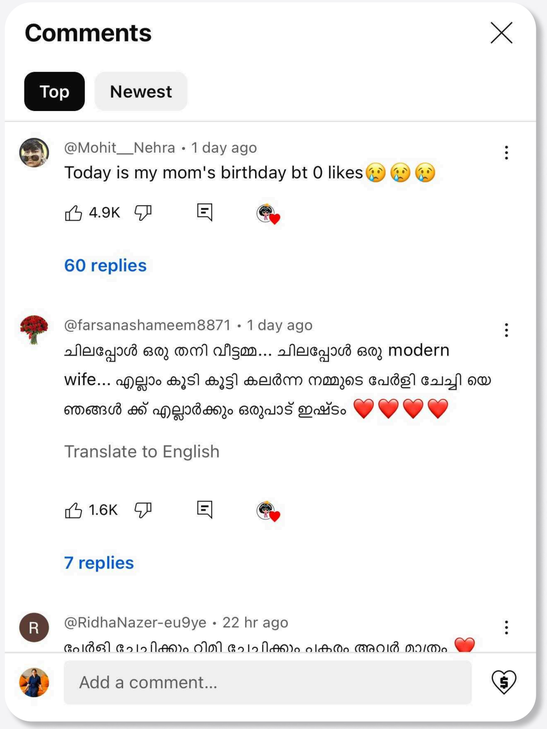
The Sidebar Menu is accessed by tapping the Navigation icon. It provides a list of content categories like **Trending**, **Music**, **Movies & TV**, **Live**, **Gaming**, and more. It also offers access to **YouTube Premium** and **Settings**.



Components

Comments Section

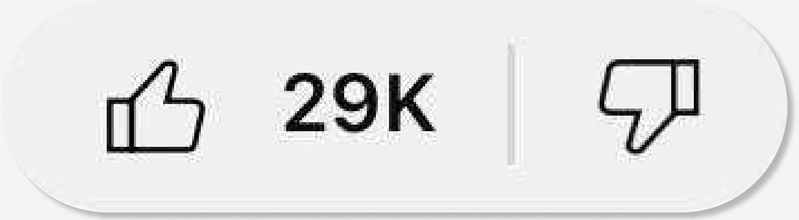
Found below each video, the **Comments Section** allows users to engage with the video content by leaving comments, replying to others, and liking/disliking comments. This fosters interaction between creators and viewers.



Components

Like/Dislike Buttons

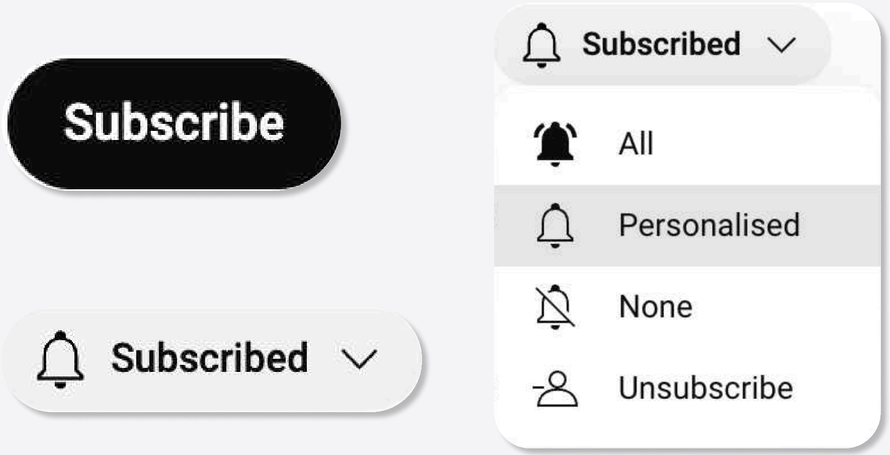
Below the video player, the **Like** and **Dislike buttons** allow users to express their opinion on the video content. These interactions help improve YouTube's algorithm for future recommendations.



Components

Subscribe Button

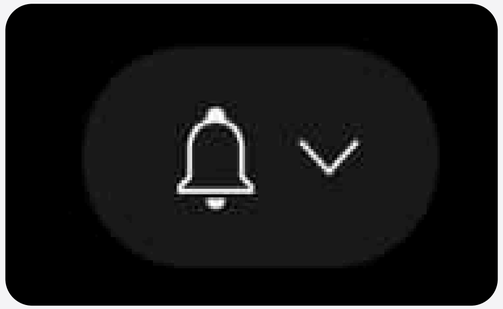
Located near the video title and channel name, the **Subscribe Button** allows users to follow a channel and receive updates on new content. When subscribed, users will see new uploads from these channels in the **Subscriptions** section.



Components

Notifications

The **Notifications** Bell icon alerts users to new videos from channels they follow, live stream events, or YouTube system updates. Users can customize notifications for individual channels.



Pattern

Cards

YouTube uses the **Cards** pattern to organize content like videos, playlists, and channels. Each card displays essential details such as thumbnails, titles, and view counts, creating a clean layout that enhances browsing and consistency across the platform.

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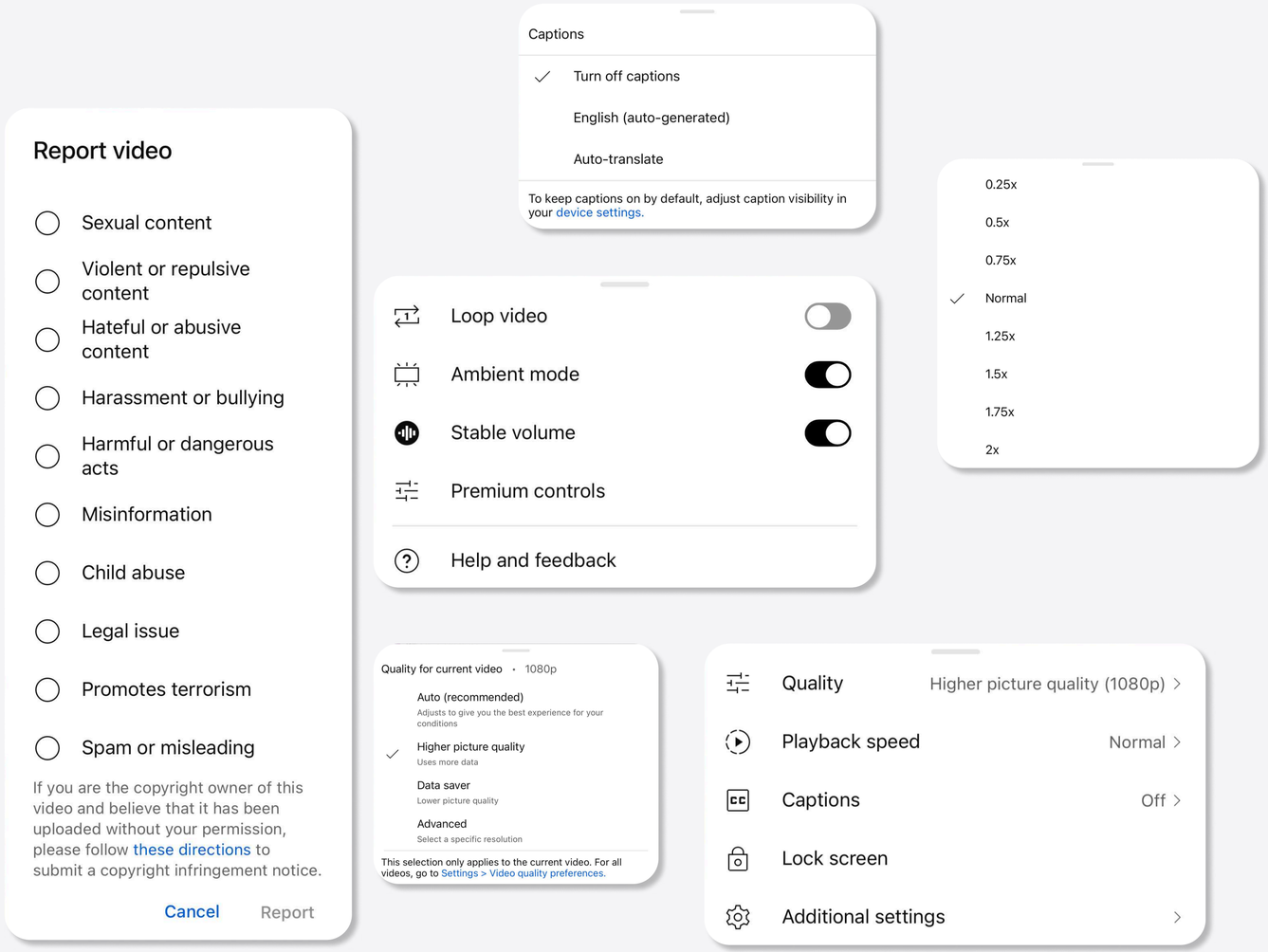
Pattern

Accordion Menu

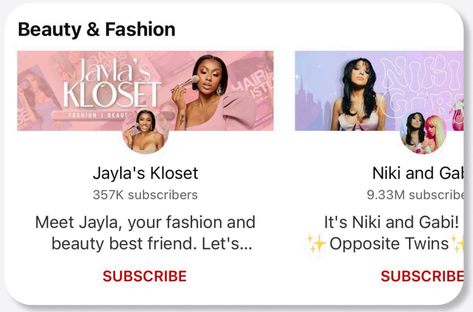
YouTube uses an **accordion menu** to display additional options or settings in a compact, expandable format. When tapped, the menu expands to reveal more features, such as sharing, adding to playlists, reporting, or adjusting video settings. This design conserves screen space while allowing users to quickly access additional controls and features without leaving the current screen.

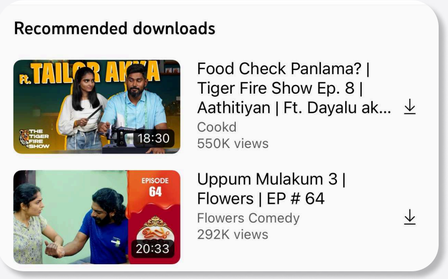


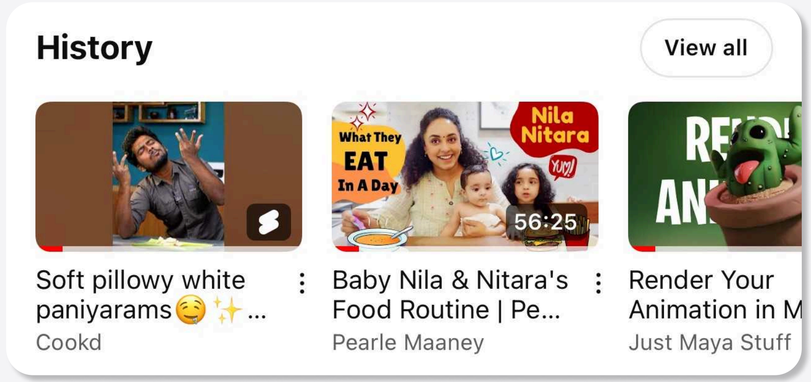
Pattern

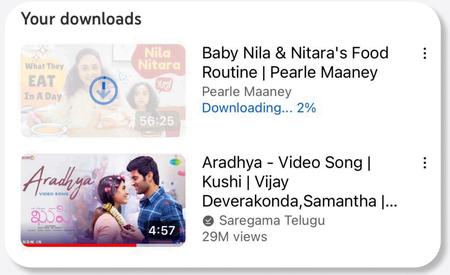
Carousel

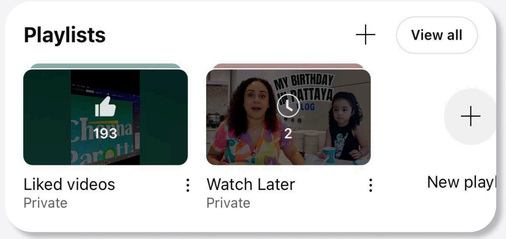
In YouTube, the Carousel pattern is used to showcase a variety of content, such as recommended videos, categories, or playlists, in a horizontally scrollable format. This design allows users to browse through multiple options, like trending videos or popular channels, without cluttering the screen.
By swiping through the carousel, users can explore a wide range of content efficiently while keeping the interface clean and easy to navigate.







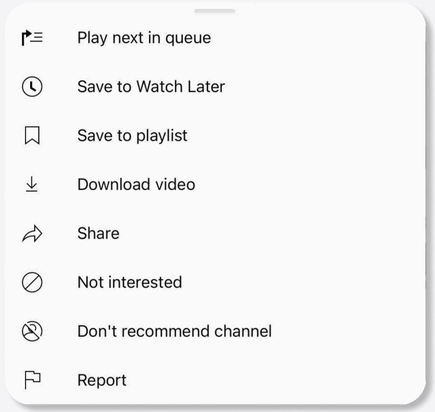


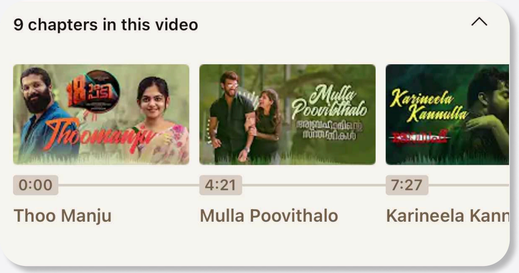


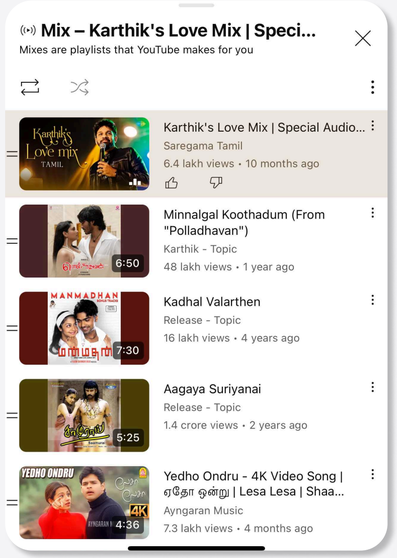
Pattern

List View

In YouTube, the List View pattern is used to display content such as video search results, playlists, or channel uploads in a vertically organized format. This view arranges videos in a clear, linear order, making it easy for users to scroll through and find specific content quickly. The list typically includes essential details like video thumbnails, titles, channel names, and view counts, offering an organized and user-friendly browsing experience.



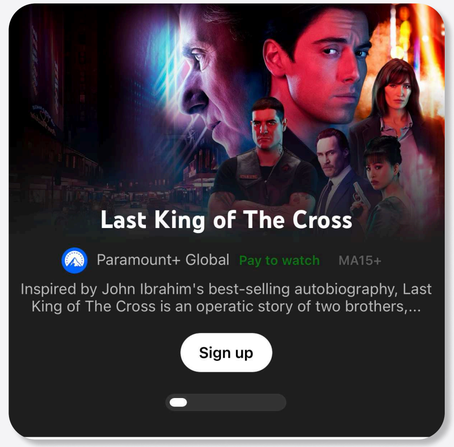


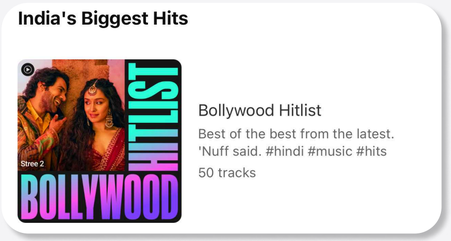


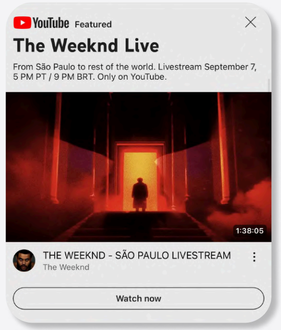
Pattern

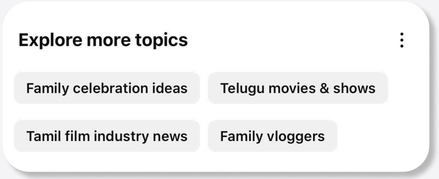
Widgets

In YouTube, the Widgets pattern provides users with quick access to essential content or controls, both on their home screen and within the app. YouTube widgets can showcase recently watched videos, trending content, or offer playback controls, allowing users to resume watching, explore new videos, or control video playback without needing to open the full app. This enhances convenience and efficiency for users, keeping them engaged with minimal effort.









Feature Proposal

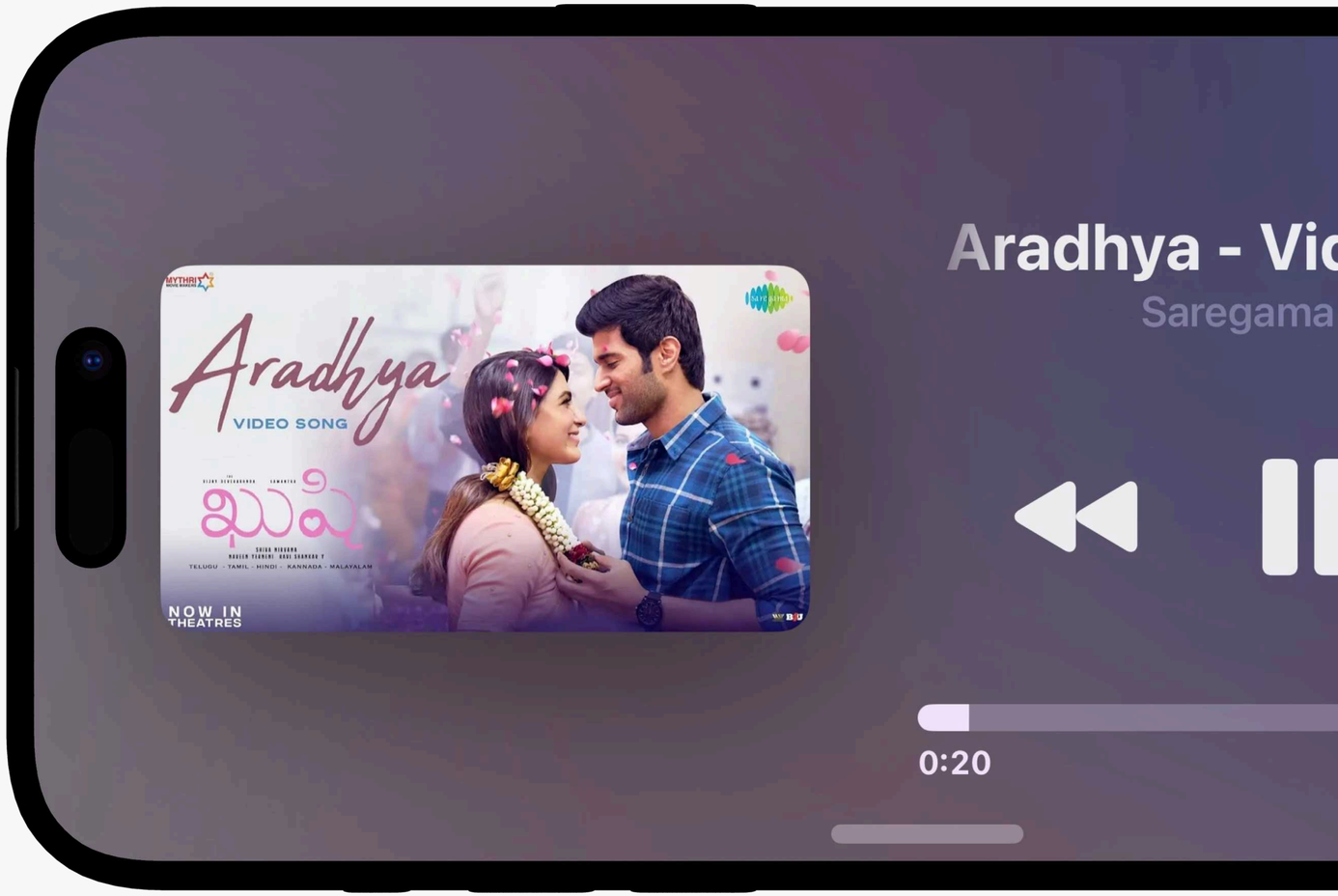
- Proposal
- Mockups

07

Proposal

Smart Video Bookmarking Feature

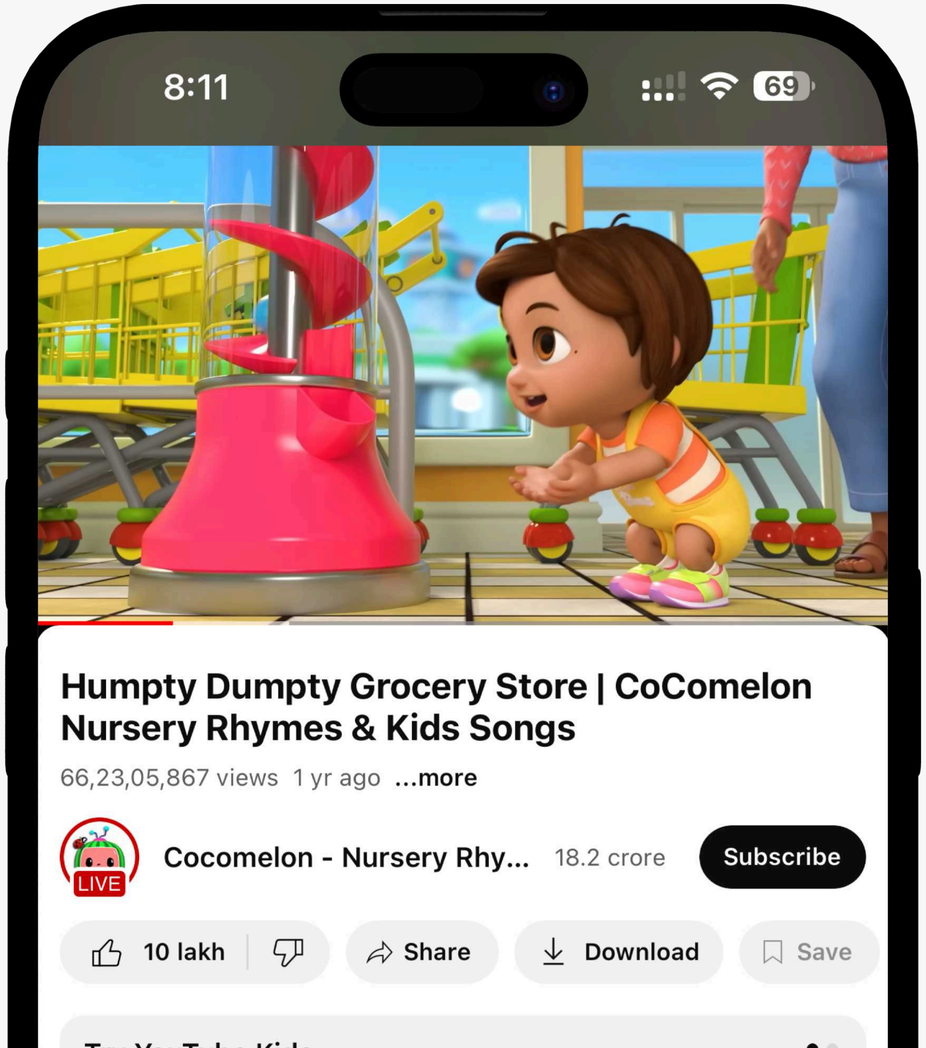
The feature I am proposing is called "Smart Video Bookmarking." This functionality would allow YouTube users to save specific timestamps within videos for easy access later. By clicking a "Bookmark" button, users can mark key moments or interesting parts of any video they are watching. These bookmarks would be saved to a dedicated "Bookmarks" tab within the user's profile, enabling quick retrieval of these saved points whenever needed.



Proposal

Why Propose This Feature?

The Smart Video Bookmarking feature addresses a common user challenge: navigating lengthy videos to find specific moments. Many users, especially those who frequently watch tutorials, lectures, or other long-form content, need to revisit key parts of a video without spending time manually searching. By offering the ability to mark important timestamps, YouTube would significantly improve content engagement, retention, and overall user experience. This feature also caters to diverse audiences, including students, professionals, and casual viewers, who would benefit from a more streamlined and organized viewing process.



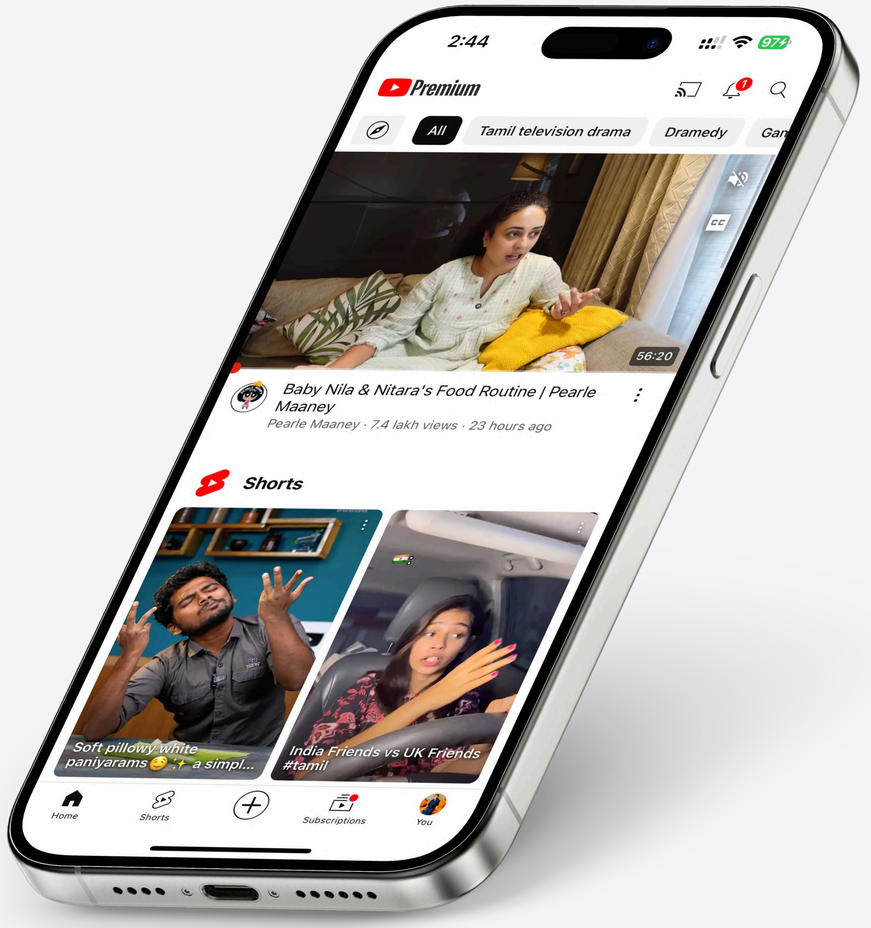
Proposal

Key Benefits

Enhanced User Experience: Users can quickly return to important sections, saving time and effort.

Improved Engagement: Encourages users to interact more deeply with videos, leading to longer watch times and higher satisfaction.

Organization: Provides a better way to manage long-form content, especially for educational and tutorial-based videos.



Proposal

Key Functionalities

Bookmark Button:

- A dedicated button placed on the video player to allow users to instantly save timestamps during playback.

Bookmarks Tab:

- A "Bookmarks" tab in the user profile where all saved timestamps are listed, complete with video titles and custom labels for each bookmark.

Custom Notes:

- Users can add notes to each bookmark to remember why they saved a particular timestamp, making it easier to find specific sections later.

Real-time Syncing:

- Bookmarks are synced across devices, allowing users to access their saved points whether they’re watching on desktop, mobile, or tablet.

Sharing Bookmarks:

- Users can share specific bookmarks with friends or colleagues, making it easier to direct others to key moments in a video.

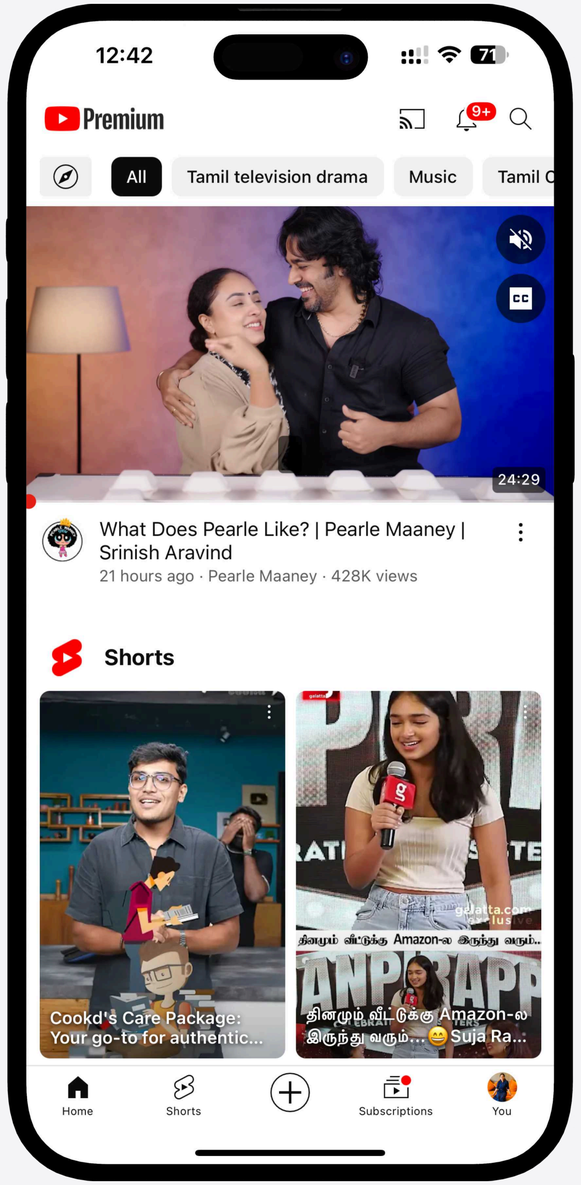
Notification for Changes:

- If a bookmarked video gets updated (e.g., the creator edits the video or adds new timestamps), the user receives a notification to stay informed about changes related to their saved content.

Proposal

Addressing the Gap in Functionality

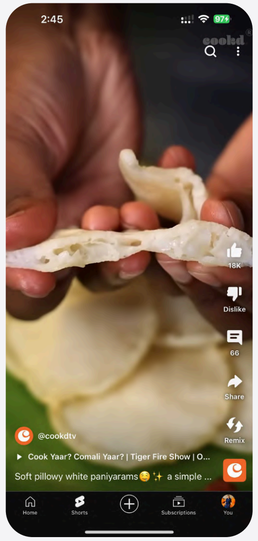
YouTube currently lacks a feature that allows users to bookmark specific moments in videos. This makes navigating long-form content like tutorials and lectures inefficient. The Smart Video Bookmarking feature fills this gap by letting users save key timestamps, improving navigation and usability. It caters to users who need quick access to important moments, enhancing the overall YouTube experience.

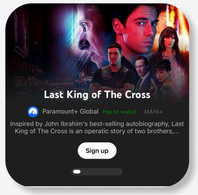


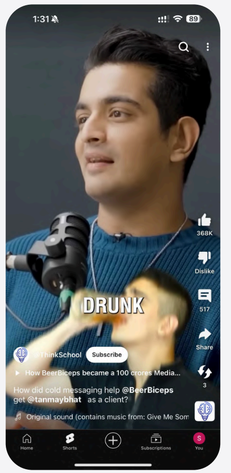
Mockups

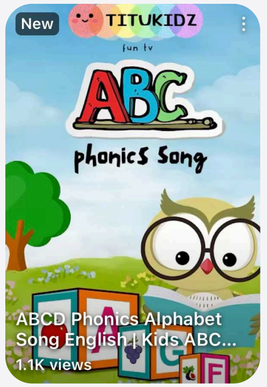
Design Consistency

In designing the Smart Video Bookmarking feature, I have ensured strict adherence to YouTube's existing design guidelines, including grids, spacing, color schemes, typography, and UI components. The feature aligns with YouTube's clean and intuitive interface, maintaining consistency with the platform's aesthetic. This ensures that the Smart Video Bookmarking feature feels like a seamless extension of YouTube's existing user experience, enhancing functionality without disrupting design flow.



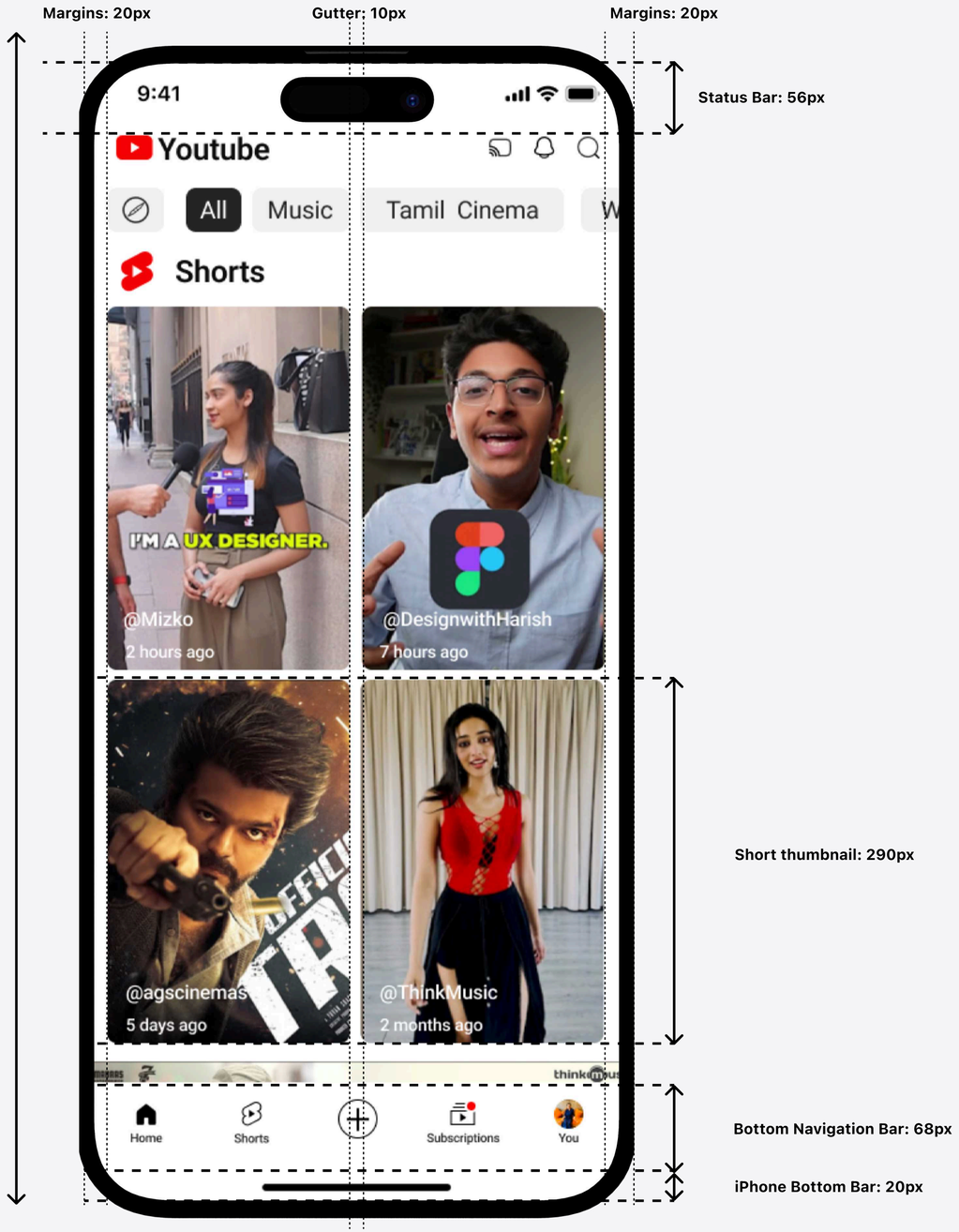




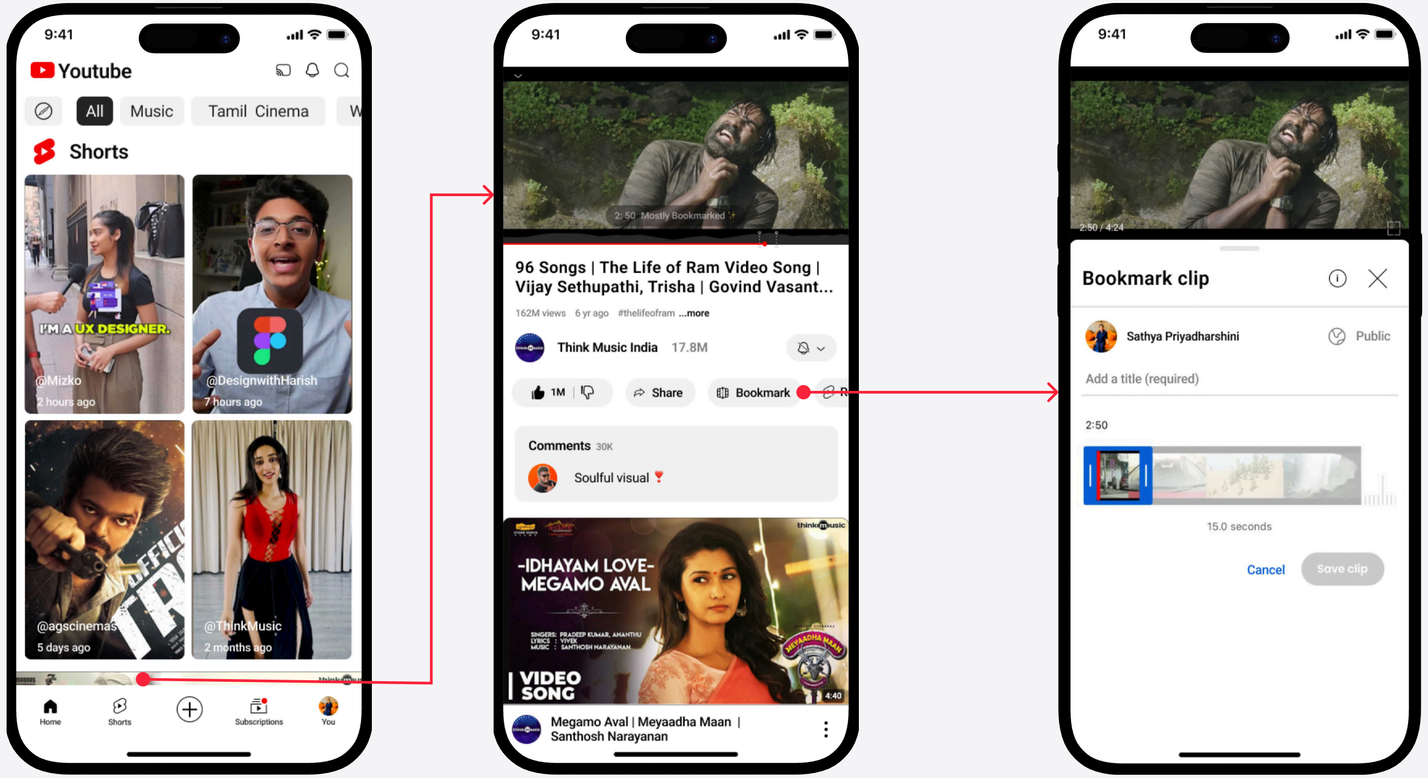


Mockups

Screen: 430px x 932px



Mockups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Shorts
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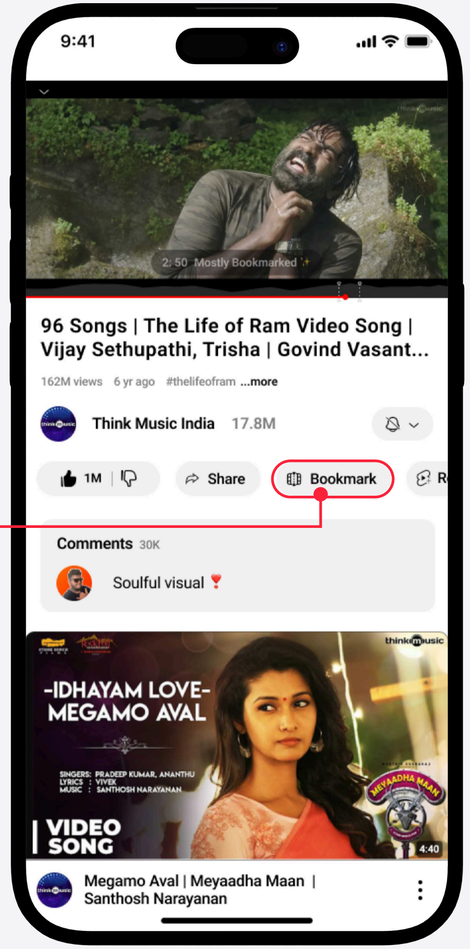
@DesignwithHarish
7 hours ago
@agscinemas
5 days ago
@ThinkMusic
2 months ago
Home
Shorts
Subscriptions
You
2:50 Mostly Bookmarked
96 Songs | The Life of Ram Video Song | Vijay Sethupathi, Trisha | Govind Vasant...
162M views 6 yr ago #thelifeofram ...more
Think Music India 17.8M
1M
Share
Bookmark
Comments 30K
Soulful visual
-IDHAYAM LOVE-
MEGAMO AVAL
VIDEO SONG
4:40
Megamo Aval | Meyaadha Maan | Santhosh Narayanan
2:50 / 4:24
Bookmark clip
Sathya Priyadharshini
Public
Add a title (required)
2:50
15.0 seconds
Cancel
Save clip

Mockups

In YouTube, the Bookmark button is conveniently placed next to the Share and Like buttons, just below the video. This strategic placement ensures easy access for users to mark specific moments within the video without interrupting the viewing experience. By positioning the Bookmark button alongside familiar actions, such as sharing and liking, YouTube maintains a consistent and intuitive interface, allowing users to quickly save key timestamps in an organized manner. This ensures that the feature feels like a natural extension of the platform's existing controls.

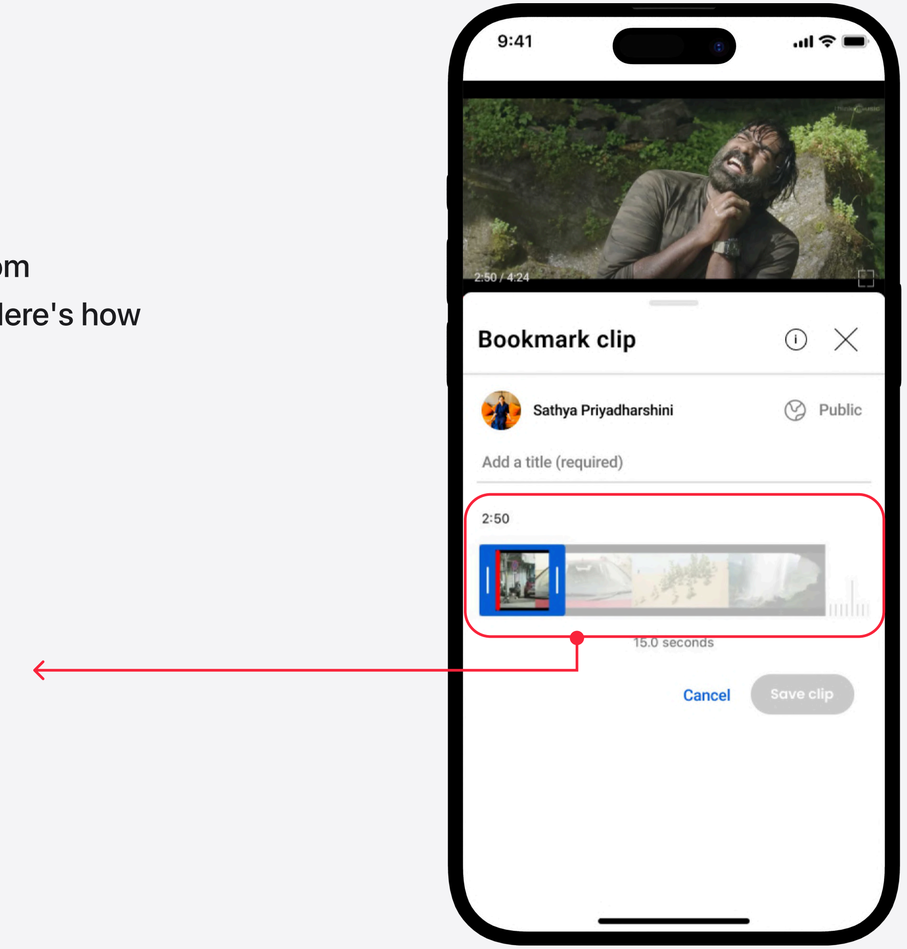


Mockups

In this Bookmark Clip screen, users can create a custom bookmark for a specific moment in a YouTube video. Here's how it works:

Timestamp: The time at which the bookmark is being set (2:50 in this case) is automatically displayed, showing the exact moment in the video the user is bookmarking.

Thumbnail Preview: A thumbnail slider at the bottom provides a visual representation of the video clip around the selected timestamp. Users can adjust the clip by dragging the slider to capture the desired section precisely.



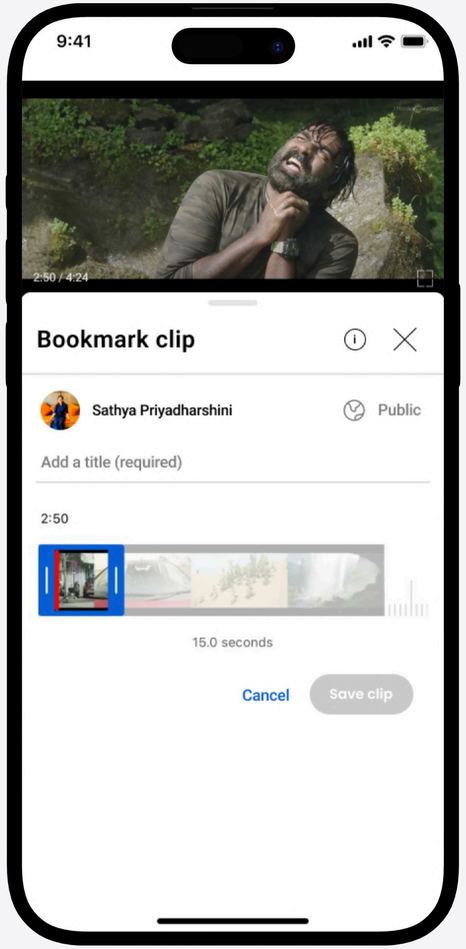
Mockups

This screen provides a simple yet powerful way for users to label and save specific moments in a video for easy access later.

Title Input: Users are prompted to add a title for the bookmark, which is a required step. This title helps users organize and remember why they saved that specific moment.

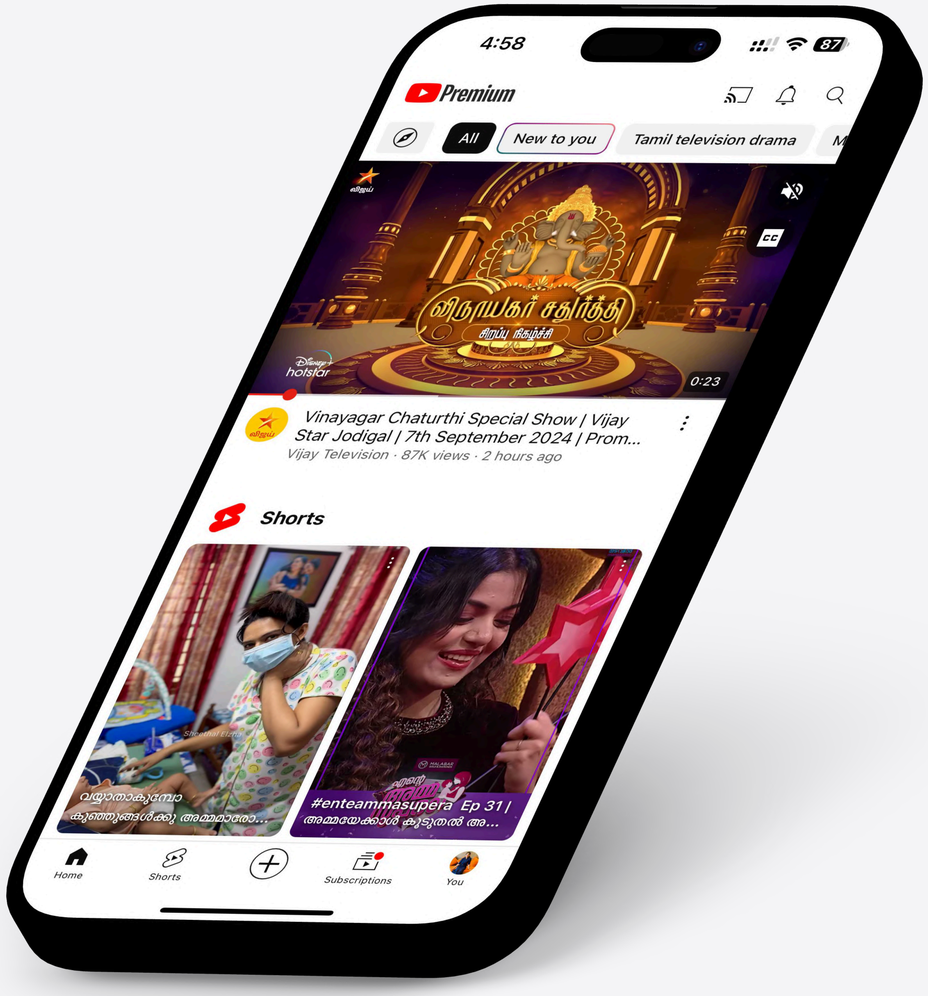
Public/Private Setting: Below the user's name, there's an option to select whether the bookmark is Public or Private. This determines if others can view the bookmarked clip.

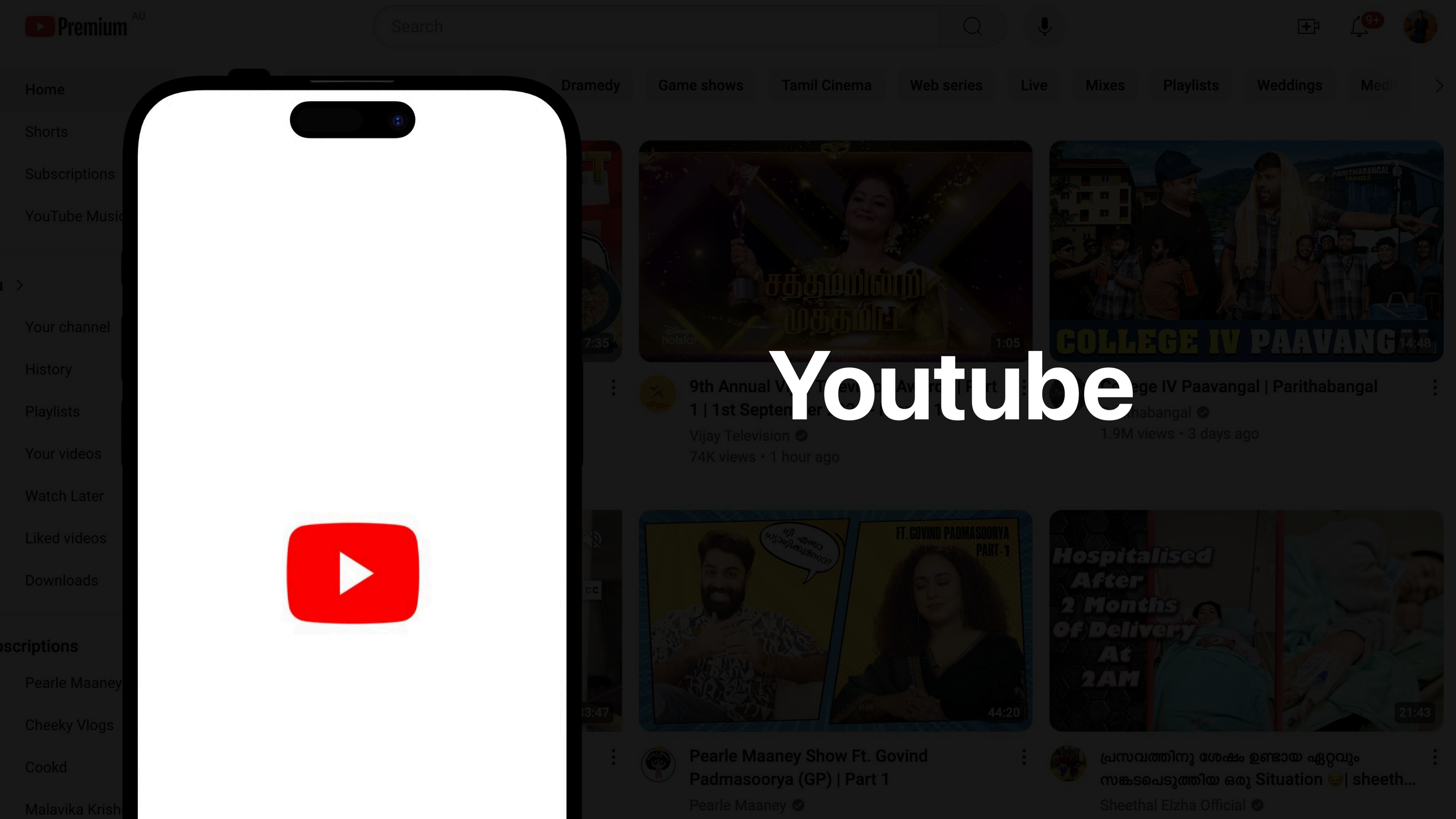
Save Clip Button: Once the user is satisfied with the selection and has added a title, they can press the Save clip button to store the bookmark in their bookmarks tab for future reference.



Conclusion

In conclusion, the Smart Video Bookmarking feature offers a practical solution to the challenge of navigating long-form content on YouTube. By allowing users to save and organize specific moments within videos, this feature greatly enhances user experience, engagement, and content retention. It is particularly beneficial for tutorials, lectures, and other educational content, where users may need to revisit key information. The seamless integration of this feature into YouTube's existing design ensures that it feels intuitive and consistent with the platform's user interface. Additionally, the feature addresses a gap in current functionality, making YouTube more versatile and user-friendly for a diverse range of audiences.

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Home
Shorts
Subscriptions
YouTube Music
Your channel
History
Playlists
Your videos
Watch Later
Liked videos
Downloads
Pearle Maaney
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Cookd
Malavika Krish
Dramedy
Game shows
Tamil Cinema
Web series
Live
Mixes
Playlists
Weddings
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1 | 1st Septe
Vijay Television
74K views • 1 hour ago
COLLEGE IV PAAVANG
14:48
ege IV Paavangal | Parithabangal
1.9M views • 3 days ago
FT. GOVIND PADMASOORYA PART-1
44:20
Pearle Maaney Show Ft. Govind Padmasoorya (GP) | Part 1
Pearle Maaney
Hospitalised After 2 Months Of Delivery At 2AM
21:43
പ്രസവത്തിനു ശേഷം ഉണ്ടായ ഏറ്റവും സങ്കടപെടുത്തിയ ഒരു Situation 😭| sheeth...
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